星
Star

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友好会晤
Lovely Meeting 5SP-01

The Star
星

Lovely Meeting
友好会晤

SPDM Library
第一防线图书馆

Sotheby: Wow! So this is the library in Vertin's school!
苏芙比：哇哦，这就是维尔汀她们上过学的图书馆……！

Sotheby: So many people here! Hmm, they're probably around my age.
苏芙比：这里的人好多呀……唔，年龄看起来，似乎和我差不多大……

A gorgeous sap-green dress jumps into the library of SPDM. Its owner keeps talking in a sing-song tone, like a chirping goldcrest.
一袭沙普绿跃入第一防线学校图书馆中，上下起伏的音调如同永不停歇的戴菊鸟儿。

Sotheby: Heh heh, we've also got this many shelves in the library of Sotheby's Manor!
苏芙比：哈哈，苏芙比庄园的藏书室也有这么多架子！

Sotheby: Are there any alchemy workshops and potion warehouses here, like in our manor?
苏芙比：这里也会像庄园一样，有炼金工坊和魔药仓库吗?

The young lady stands on tiptoe, looking around this place curiously.
小淑女踮起脚尖，好奇地左右张望。

Sotheby: Where can I find Ms. Bouanich? Madam Z told me to come here, but she didn't give any other clues.
苏芙比：我要怎么找到布翁尼小姐呢？Z 女士只告诉我来第一防线学校的图书馆。

Sotheby: *sighs* The people here really need Mr. Teakettler, who is always nice and warm to the guests. Just twist his teapot ear, then he can take you anywhere.
苏芙比：唉，这儿是多么需要一位善良而温顺的提科特勒【Teakettler】先生啊！——只要摇晃它的茶壶耳朵，客人们就会被带到任何想去的地方。

Sotheby: If not so, placing a Luck-A-Day Potion at the entrance would help as well.
苏芙比：或者是在门廊处放上一瓶“好运一整天”的药水……

Sotheby: If I had made it before I came, Ms. Bouanich and I might have met by now. Or she will just pop up behind me!
苏芙比：如果我提前调配好，就一定不会发生这种事了！布翁尼小姐也会欣然出现在我身后！

Matilda: Are you looking for me?
玛蒂尔达：你在找我吗?

Sotheby: Oh, my word!
苏芙比：哇啊！吓了我一跳……！

Sotheby: Oops, that was too loud. Where are my manners!
苏芙比：唔，好像有点太大声了，要注意形象。

Sotheby straightens the wrinkles on her dress and gives out her hand like a real lady.
苏芙比赶紧捋了捋裙摆上的褶皱，像真正的淑女般朝玛蒂尔达微微探手。

Sotheby: Nice to meet you! Are you Ms. Bouanich?
苏芙比：你好！请问，你是布翁尼小姐吗?

The other girl nods haughtily. Her uniform speaks for herself.
身着制服的可人儿高傲地点了点头，显然这一事实是毋庸置疑的。

It seems to be a historic "first meeting" for them.
这似乎是一场颇具历史性的“首次会晤”。

Sotheby: That's fantastic. How did you find me? Did you see me in the Oneiromancy? Or through a crystal orb?
苏芙比：太厉害了，你竟然能直接找到我的位置——是预知梦吗？还是水晶球的占卜术？

Sotheby: Either way, it is the great arcanum ...
苏芙比：不论是哪一种，都是相当了不起的神秘学……

Matilda: Hah! I'm much greater than that. Look at you, dressed as if you'd just been to a ball. You are as eye-catching as ... the pigment poured on a sketch!
玛蒂尔达：哈！这可没什么了不起的。你穿得像刚从舞会里出来似的，在这儿，就像是素描画被泼了油彩一样显眼。

Matilda: I saw you the moment I came into the library!
玛蒂尔达：我一眼就看到你了！

Sotheby: A ball? Ha! Does the Foundation hold balls, too?
苏芙比：舞会？基金会里也会有舞会么？

Matilda: No, I'm saying ... Hmm, does every friend of Vertin's talk this way?
玛蒂尔达：……嗯，不，我想说的是……维尔汀带回来的朋友们都是这样的吗？

Matilda: Never mind. Madam Z told me you wanted to look up the materials on "the mysterious school that believes in numbers" here.
玛蒂尔达：总之，Z 女士已经和我说过了，你们想在这里查阅信奉数字的教派的资料。

Sotheby: That's right! Ms. Moissan told me she will thoroughly check the documents in the Foundation archive, so I'll go through the books in the SPDM library!
苏芙比：是的！莫桑老师说基金会档案库的资料由她来负责，那么……第一防线学校的图书馆就交给我了！

Sotheby: If we can find anything about that school, we can be of more help to Vertin and her team!
苏芙比：如果我们能查到教派的信息，就能帮上维尔汀他们更多的忙！

Matilda: I'm sorry, Ms. Sotheby, but I'm afraid this situation is going to disappoint you.
玛蒂尔达：很遗憾，苏芙比小姐，现实恐怕要令你失望了。

Matilda: While you spent the last hour looking for Teakettler's ear, the kindhearted monitor assistant already gained the valuable access to the library. But I haven't found any records regarding "the mysterious school that believes in numbers" yet.
玛蒂尔达：在你寻找提科特勒的茶壶耳朵的一个小时里，慷慨的纪律辅员申请了宝贵的查阅权限，但还是没能在图书馆里找到任何与数字相关的密教活动记录。

Like a bolt out of the blue.
这真是晴天霹雳。

Sotheby: Oh! But, but Ms. Moissan said, there are soooo many books here that they can cover the entire back of a Stronsay Beast!
苏芙比：啊……可是，可是莫桑老师告诉我，这儿的书本多得能装满斯特朗赛的整个背脊！

Matilda: That's a bit exaggerated, but, ahem, she's right!
玛蒂尔达：虽然有点夸张，但是——咳，她说得确实没错！

Matilda: Nevertheless, the librarian was transferred to a more important position years ago due to the "Storm."
玛蒂尔达：不过，前几年受到“暴雨”的影响，负责管理的人员被抽调到了其他更重要的岗位上。

Matilda: Many old books are not yet sorted. Some even went missing in the chaos.
玛蒂尔达：许多古老的书籍都来不及重新归整，甚至还有一些在混乱中遗失了……

Matilda: The only relevant materials I could find are the stories of Pythagoras and some books on mathematical theorems, but I don't think they have anything to do with Vertin's issue.
玛蒂尔达：我只找到了毕达哥拉斯的传说和定理集，但它们似乎与维尔汀的处境关联不大……

What Matilda sees now is a pair of tear-dimmed eyes.
布翁尼小姐对上了一双水雾朦胧的眼睛。

Sotheby: That means ... I can't do anything to help them?
苏芙比：所以我……帮不上大家的忙了吗?

Matilda: Please stop being emotional. It doesn't work on this professional member of the Foundation!
玛蒂尔达：请停止你的情绪化行为，这对恪尽职守的基金会职员毫无作用！

She looks away and clears her throat like a grown-up.
玛蒂尔达匆忙转移视线，故作成熟地清了清嗓子。

Matilda: Ahem! Without field investigation permission, I can't take you out to collect information.
玛蒂尔达：没有外出许可，我也不能带你去外面收集资料。

Matilda: But in fact, there is still another reference room only known to the most outstanding monitor assistant.
玛蒂尔达：不过事实上，还有一个放着资料的地方，只有最优秀、最杰出的协助辅员才会知道……

Sotheby: **Hooray!**
苏芙比：**好耶——！**

Other students in the library cast disgruntled glances at them.
正在看书的学生投来了不满的目光。

Matilda: Shh, shh! It's a violation to make noises in the library! Please follow me, Ms. Sotheby!
玛蒂尔达：嘘，嘘——！在图书馆大声喧哗是违反纪律的！
苏芙比小姐，请到这边来！

Tall shelves.
高耸的书架。

Unfamiliar surroundings.
陌生的环境。

An impossible mission.
机会渺茫的任务。

The girls walk through the shelves like fish swimming through coral.
女孩们穿梭其中，如同灵巧而活泼的游鱼。

Sotheby: Thank you so much, Ms. Bouanich.
苏芙比：布翁尼小姐，谢谢你的帮忙。

Sotheby: You mentioned "ball." I haven't heard that word for a very long time.
苏芙比：你刚刚说到舞会……我，我已经很久没有听到这个词了。

Sotheby: I remember what Mr. Karson, my butler, had taught me. He said, "Express your gratitude to fair ladies by holding a grand ball."
苏芙比：我还记得……卡森先生曾经说过，我们应以盛大舞会答谢淑女的美德。

Sotheby: I'll write to my father and ask for a brand-new, unsinkable, and maneuverable rock 'n' roll park. I'm sure he will gladly say yes.
苏芙比：我准备给父亲写一封信，他一定会再为我们赞助一艘全新的、不会沉没的移动摇滚公国。

Matilda: Maneuverable rock 'n' roll park?
玛蒂尔达：……移动摇滚公国?

Sotheby: Yes! We can hold a twist ball on it when Vertin and her team are back!
苏芙比：等维尔汀他们回来，我们可以一起在那儿举行一场最酷的扭扭舞会……！

Matilda: Please allow me to say NO! The monitor assistant of SPDM will never participate in such an inelegant activity.
玛蒂尔达：我拒绝！第一防线学校的纪律辅员绝不参加扭扭舞这种粗鲁的肢体运动。

Matilda: Wait. Did you just say Vertin and "her team"?
玛蒂尔达：等等——你刚刚说维尔汀“她们”……?

Sotheby: ...?
苏芙比：……?

Matilda: Ahem, we can talk about the ball later.
玛蒂尔达：……咳咳，舞会的邀请先放到一边。

Matilda: The kindhearted Matilda Bouanich will try her best to help you with the task. But o-of course, it's only out of her sense of responsibility, not for some personal reasons.
玛蒂尔达：善良的玛蒂尔达·布翁尼会尽力帮助你完成任务……当、当然，这可不是因为别的什么乱七八糟的原因。

They go faster and faster.
淑女们的脚步越发迅捷。

Finally, they reach their destination.
终于，她们抵达了终点。

"Unnecessary Information" Room
“非必要信息”资料室

To patch the fragmented eras in the future ...
为了便于给将来的时代缝补上应有的片段……

And to store the currently unimportant files and reports ...
也为了收容眼下尚不紧要的文件与报告……

People built this reference room in the shape of a box with gray and white walls.
人们把它做成了类似的小方匣子，并抹上灰白的墙面。

During this awful time, which might last for ages, people call it—
在这段也许会持续许久的糟糕时间里，或许可以称之为——

The footnote of history.
历史的注脚。

Matilda: Here we are: the reference room storing "unnecessary information." It's a place ignored by most staff.
玛蒂尔达：我们到了——这儿是“非必要信息”资料室……一个被大部分职员忽略的地方。

Matilda: Even so, this careful, reliable monitor assistant will not let go of any details.
玛蒂尔达：但认真可靠的纪律辅员不会容许任何一处疏漏。

She knocks on the rusty sign haughtily.
她得意地敲了敲那块生锈的门牌。

Matilda: I hereby officially appoint you as the chief assistant of monitor assistant of SPDM! I will take my responsibility and teach you how to become a devoted Foundation member!
玛蒂尔达：现在，我正式任命你为第一防线学校纪律辅员的第一助理！我会负起责任，教导你如何成为一位尽职的职员！

Matilda pulls off the cloth covering the archive cabinet.
玛蒂尔达一把拉下了文件柜上盖着的罩布。

Dust rises in the air.
灰尘飞扬起来。

Matilda: Here is your first task: read through these unsorted, old files, all of them.
玛蒂尔达：派给你的任务——就是把这些没有编目的陈旧资料都看一遍。

The monitor assistant takes a dusty file from the cabinet. The paper inside has already turned yellow.
纪律协助辅员拿下一份蒙尘的文件，里面的纸质已经发黄。

Matilda: I have searched all the archived ones. These are the last parts.
玛蒂尔达：可以检索的资料我都已经找过了，只剩这些了。

Matilda: Most of them are discarded administrative documents, low-priority materials, and substandard reports written by rookie investigators.
玛蒂尔达：它们大抵是已淘汰的行政文件，或是被判定为低优先级的冗余资料，还有新手调查员被打回的不合规报告……

Matilda: By the way, you should know I didn't sort any of them out for you, and they don't necessarily have what you want!
玛蒂尔达：事先说明，这可不是我特意为你们筛选出来的，也不代表你们能从中得到想要的信息！

Sotheby: It's alright! Leave them to me! I love reading!
苏芙比：没关系，这些都交给我吧！我很喜欢看书！

Matilda: Humph! You'd better do.
玛蒂尔达：哼……但愿如此。

Matilda: Here's the key. Keep it safe. You can sit on the cushion there when you sort out the files. I-I don't want your dress to stain the stone bench.
玛蒂尔达：这是钥匙，拿好它……那儿有软垫，你可以坐在那儿整理。我，我可不希望你的裙摆弄脏这儿的石凳。

Matilda: I'll go see if I missed any files. Listen! This monitor assistant will test you on your familiarity with these files when she's back!
玛蒂尔达：我去确认一下还有没有其他缺失的文件。听好了，今天结束后，本纪律协助辅员将会来抽查你的成果！

Three Hours Later
三小时后

Matilda: Double check completed. Looks like I didn't miss any relevant files.
玛蒂尔达：重新又检查了一遍……看来我并没有遗漏任何相关的文件。

Matilda: Phew! Quite a long day.
玛蒂尔达：呼啊……有点累了。

Matilda: I doubt if that spoiled lady can finish all the materials. She must have been bored and fallen asleep, waiting for her Teakettler in the dream ...
玛蒂尔达：不过，那位大小姐真的能看完那些枯燥的文书吗？说不定，她已经无聊得睡着了，还在梦里等着茶壶耳朵来接她呢……

Matilda: It takes much more than dancing at balls to be a Foundation investigator.
玛蒂尔达：基金会调查专员可不是办办派对，跳跳舞就能担任的～

Matilda: I'll send her back to that teacher when she wakes up.
玛蒂尔达：等她从梦里醒来，就把她送回那个女教师那里。

Matilda: In the end, it will be the kindhearted Matilda who finishes the task for her. Being a great monitor assistant comes with great responsibility!
玛蒂尔达：到头来，还是需要好心的玛蒂尔达帮她完成任务……完美无缺的辅员可不是那么好当的！

Again, Matilda gently pushes the door open.
玛蒂尔达轻轻推开资料室的门。

Surprisingly, she is welcomed with an energetic greeting.
出乎意料的是，她得到了一声热情洋溢的友好招呼。

Sotheby: Oh, Ms. Bouanich!
苏芙比：啊，玛蒂尔达小姐！

Standing on a ladder, Sotheby gives her a big smile with a stack of files in her hand.
苏芙比很有精神地站在梯子上，手上拿着一卷文书。

The files she didn't finish reading are scattered on the ground, while the others have been well organized in the cabinet.
地上散落着阅读中的资料，已经读毕的都被好好地归拢在了书架一角。

Matilda: You ... You didn't fall asleep? Did you sort out these files?
玛蒂尔达：你……你没有睡着吗？这些分类……是你做的吗?

Sotheby: Hmm? Yes! And I love these books in uncommon shapes! There are so many wonderful stories!
苏芙比：嗯？是的！苏芙比很喜欢看这些奇形怪状的书，它们记载了好多精彩的故事……

Sotheby: I often read books with Sasana when Father wasn't at home. We read and read until the Redcomb Aves woke up the sun. Moreover, these files are much easier than Ms. Moissan's reading task.
苏芙比：父亲不在家的时候，莎莎娜会陪我看书，直到红冠尖喙兽们叫醒太阳。再说，这些资料比莫桑老师的作业要少多啦～

Sotheby: Here, the gentleman from River Conwy tamed a whole group of Afancs! How marvellous is that!
苏芙比：你看！这位来自康威河畔的先生居然独自驯服了一整群寻水兽【Afanc】，真了不起！

Matilda: Oh, okay. Looks like you meet the basic requirements for being a rookie investigator!
玛蒂尔达：……好，好吧……看来你还是具备了一些新手调查员的基本素养！

Matilda: I-I guess you are qualified to be my chief assistant.
玛蒂尔达：作为我的第一助理……算，算是合格了吧。

The young lady doesn't pay much attention to the mumbles from the monitor assistant.
小淑女没有在意纪律辅员的嘀嘀咕咕。

She is busy announcing her big discovery.
她忙着宣布自己的发现。

Sotheby: And I also found this interesting report! It tells a lot about the "Storm" and the "numbers."
苏芙比：我找到了一份很有趣的报告！它提到了很多和“暴雨”以及“数字”相关的内容……

Sotheby: Oh! Will this be helpful to Vertin?
苏芙比：它会帮到维尔汀吗?

Matilda: Hmm? Show it to me.
玛蒂尔达：唔？让我看看……

She takes a pile of yellowed paper from Sotheby.
苏芙比将一叠泛黄的纸张递了过来。

This neat and orderly written report has no beginning or end.
这份报告没有起始，但上面的笔迹工整而清晰。

Obviously, the author is a meticulous person.
似乎可以从中窥见记录者一丝不苟的性格。

Matilda: "... I have to say, it is undoubtedly a violation to submit such a report, but it will be a travesty of the truth and human sense if I cover it up."
玛蒂尔达：“……我承认，递交这样一份报告无疑是不合规定的。可将它隐瞒下来，也是对真相和人类理智的践踏。”

Matilda & Writer of the Report: Peace, sense, justice—they have always been the creeds in my heart, and are now the reason why I have decided to write down the whole thing.
玛蒂尔达 & 记录者：“和平、理性和公义，这些信条从未偏离我的内心，因此我最终决定如实写下这一切。”

Writer of the Report: A long time has passed since the first attack of the most severe crisis in our time. But we are still wondering, what on earth does it mean?
记录者：我们时代最显著、最深刻的危机已经降临许久了——可是，它究竟意味着什么？

Writer of the Report: That was the eve of the millennium, of which no one had any memories, illogically. The next day, time was already reversed to 1996 the moment we opened our eyes.
记录者：在无人铭记的千禧年之夜，睁开眼睛的短促瞬间，时间回退到了 1996 年。

Writer of the Report: We walked out of the building made of gray and white marble as usual, hardly aware that the sun we bathed in was from another time.
记录者：那时我们茫然无知地走出灰白相间的水泥屋檐，浑然不觉清晨的阳光已经属于一个陌生的时代。

Writer of the Report: Our survival was unexpected and almost unbelievable in such a calamity which swept the globe.
记录者：在这样一场全球性的时间灾害中，我们的幸免是如此突兀。

Writer of the Report: Why did the headquarters of the Foundation survive the reverse? Why couldn't we find our younger selves in the outside world? Did any other regions survive it as we did? What was the cause behind this calamity?
记录者：——为何基金会总部未倒回至 1996 年？为何我们没有在外面的世界见到过去的自己？地球上是否还有其他未被回退的区域？这一切的原因又是什么？

Writer of the Report: I didn't know, nor did anyone else.
记录者：我不知道。没有人知道。

Writer of the Report: Things remained unclear until time was reversed again. This time, we all witnessed that rain in the '80s.
记录者：直到时间再一次倒退，我们都见证了 80 年代的那场雨。

Matilda: ...!
玛蒂尔达：……！

Sotheby: Are these files Vertin needs?
苏芙比：这是维尔汀他们需要的资料吗？

Matilda: I, I think so.
玛蒂尔达：我想……是的。

She says in a trembling voice.
她的声音藏着细微的颤抖。

This monitor assistant, who always claims to have a cool head, has never panicked so much.
自诩冷静的纪律辅员鲜有如此慌乱的时刻。

Matilda: It's a report written by someone who witnessed the "Storm"!
玛蒂尔达：这竟然是一份“暴雨”亲历者写下的记录……！

Matilda: And it has recorded the "Storms" before Vertin became the Timekeeper?!
玛蒂尔达：而且这记录的是……维尔汀成为“司辰”之前的“暴雨”？

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

湿透的科学
Soaked Science 5SP-02

Soaked Science
湿透的科学

Sotheby: Before she became the Timekeeper?
苏芙比：维尔汀成为“司辰”之前……？

Sotheby: Whoa! So, Vertin wasn't born a Timekeeper!
苏芙比：咦～原来维尔汀不是一开始就是司辰的吗？

Matilda: She didn't tell you that? Wait, no one is born a Timekeeper. It's not an inherited title!
玛蒂尔达：她没有告诉你吗？……不对，谁也不会一出生下来就是司辰吧，这又不是什么世袭爵位！

Matilda: Anyway, this report includes the secret chronology only accessible to the core members of the Foundation. You can only check it under the supervision of the monitor assistant before you become a qualified investigator.
玛蒂尔达：总之，这是基金会内的核心成员才能知晓的机密年表。在你成为真正的调查员之前，你的查阅行为都需要在纪律辅员的监督下进行。

Matilda dusts off the folder carefully.
玛蒂尔达小心翼翼地掸去了档案袋上的灰尘。

Matilda: No matter what the reason is, it shouldn't have been shoved in this dusty room like rubbish.
玛蒂尔达：无论如何，它不应该被粗暴地塞在这个满是灰尘的地方。

Matilda: To evaluate its authenticity and risk, the genius Matilda Bouanich will fulfill her duty as the monitor assistant and carry out a thorough inspection of this report!
玛蒂尔达：为了评估它的……真实性和风险性，天才玛蒂尔达·布翁妮要履行纪律辅员的职责，对它进行一次详细的检查！

Matilda: If you agree to this resolution, please nod, Assistant Sotheby.
玛蒂尔达：如果你认可这一处理决议，请点一点你的头，苏芙比助理。

The speech is full of terminologies Sotheby has never heard of, but it doesn't matter. Based on the tone of the speech, she has already decided how to answer—
这段话充满了晦涩而陌生的名词。但好在淑女早就决定了自己的回答——

Sotheby: Hoor- ... Yes!
苏芙比：好……好的！

Writer of the Report: That was 1985, a gloomy, miserable night compared to that peaceful morning in 1996, when we were only bothered by confusion.
记录者：如果 1996 年是一个懵懂无知的清晨，1985 年就是一个惨无人道的黑夜。

Writer of the Report: We didn't expect time to be reversed again, nor did we understand the consequence.
记录者：没有人料到时间还会再度倒退。也没有人知道倒退意味着什么。

Writer of the Report: Even now, I still remember Paulina's desperate cry. One of her hands was already inside the safe area when she fell at the entrance to the headquarters, and that was the only part of her left to us the next second.
记录者：时至今日，我仍能想起保利娜的悲鸣。她倒在了总部大门的入口，只有一只手进入了安全区——上面还戴着她订婚时的戒指。

Writer of the Report: The only legacies we found were an engagement ring on that hand and her favorite blue polka dot scarf, which we used to wrap her remains in the end.
记录者：她最爱的蓝色波点丝巾掉在一旁，我们用它包裹了这仅有的遗体。

Writer of the Report: To be honest, I admired those who still remained calm, and sympathized with the arcanists on the edge of mental breakdown. It had nothing to do with the one-quarter arcanist blood in my body; it was only the kind of empathy which all mankind would share out of instinct in the face of a hopeless calamity.
记录者：我敬佩那些依然保持冷静的同事，也理解那些濒临崩溃的神秘学家。这和我四分之一的神秘学家血统无关，只是人类在无可逆转的巨大悲剧前的本能共情。

Writer of the Report: We lost many ... too many colleagues. In the materials they sent back, we even saw all the horrifying phenomena, such as one's veins turning into electric wires.
记录者：我们失去了许多同僚。在他们留下的记录中，许多人记录了血管异变为电线的惊异光景。

Writer of the Report: Since then, the "Storm," a word simply taken from visual observation, has been used to refer to the calamity.
记录者：“暴雨”，一个过分直观的词，它在那之后开始使用。

Writer of the Report: Of course, we can have a word for the calamity itself, but what words should we use to conclude all the absurdity and panic?
记录者：我们能用它指代这场奇观。可是，我们能用什么指代所有的荒诞和惶然?

Writer of the Report: Before the "Storm," we were all familiar with time. It was supposed to be a straight line connecting the past and the future.
记录者：时间，我们都知道它。它本该是连接过去和未来之间的一条直线。

Writer of the Report: We followed the line to move forward: We broke free from ignorance, we built civilizations, we developed technologies, we promoted the well-being of mankind, and we improved our living conditions step by step. We were so sure that we were making progress on the right path.
记录者：因此我们直线前进。我们离开蒙昧，建立文明，发展科技，推动人类的福祉，改善居住的条件。我们确信自己行走在进步的坦途上。

Writer of the Report: But then, the path was taken away all of a sudden.
记录者：——现在这条路却从脚下被抽走了。

Writer of the Report: Oh, time, our closest old friend, where are you taking us?
记录者：时间，我们最熟悉的老朋友。你要把我们带回哪里?

Writer of the Report: Back to the two most painful war times in the 20th century? The era when no one had ever heard the hiss of steam engines? Or the century when mankind was yet to be enlightened?
记录者：带回 20 世纪最大的两次浩劫？带回第一台蒸汽机未曾鸣响之时？带回启蒙的曙光未曾照亮之处?

Writer of the Report: So far, mankind has achieved a lot in history: dynamos, automobiles, flyovers, railways, hospitals, poorhouses ... But if it goes on like this, what is the point of all the efforts we have made?
记录者：那样我们所有的努力……这些发电机、汽车、高架桥、铁路、医院、救济所……又有什么意义？

Writer of the Report: Now, we are like a shipwreck left on the island of time, witnessing the fall of the whole modern world in the unstoppable tsunami.
记录者：我们就像时间孤岛上的难民，注视着整个现代世界在海潮中陨落。

Writer of the Report: Even though the Foundation has lost a lot of staff members, they are still doing fine compared to Laplace.
记录者：基金会损失了许多同僚，可是科算中心的混乱比这还要严重。

Writer of the Report: My younger brother was a good example. He was the most sensible person I have ever known. On the first day of the second reverse, he told me, in a calm manner ...
记录者：我弟弟是我认识的人中最为理性的。在时代再度倒退的第一天，他冷静地告诉我：

???: "At least we have reaffirmed that Newton was right. There was never an arrow of time in classical mechanics. Hahaha! Neither in relativity nor quantum mechanics!"
???：“至少我们再次验证了牛顿是多么的正确。因为经典力学从来没有给出时间箭头——哈！相对论和量子力学里也没有！”

???: "That means this is absolutely normal! Whether the time goes backwards or forwards, even if it starts spinning around like a table top foosball player, they're not against the law of physics. We can go back in time and give Poincaré a medal of Great Prophet!"
???：“所以这是完全正常的！无论时间是前进、倒放，还是旋转着踢一段桌上足球，都是合乎物理规律的。我们甚至还能穿越回去给庞加莱颁个预言奖！”

Writer of the Report: The next day, he almost fell off the sixth floor due to excessive drinking.
记录者：第二天，他因为过量饮酒，险些从六楼向下摔死。

Writer of the Report: All the perceptions of time and space developed to this day were overthrown. We couldn't find any theories to explain the "Storm" in any existing researches. There could only be two reasons for this situation ...
记录者：一切旧有的时空观念都被粉碎了，我们无从在已知的任何一种学科里找到“暴雨”的解释。

Writer of the Report: Either we've been completely wrong all the time ...
记录者：要么，我们一直以来完全错了。

Writer of the Report: Or, we've come to a brand new world.
记录者：要么，世界在一夜之间再也不同了。

Writer of the Report: And this new world can never make sense in the way of science, or that of physics. It cannot be verified by an independent third party, and it is impossible to be comprehended through reasoning.
记录者：而这个新世界……不可能是科学的，也不可能是物理的。它不可独立验证，不可被理性理解。

Writer of the Report: Is it true that we've been going the wrong way? Is it true that those once proven wrong by history, those arcanists who claimed to possess Gnosis, are actually on the right path?
记录者：难道我们真的一直错了……？难道那些被历史放逐之人……那些宣称自己拥有灵知的神秘学家们……才是正确的？

Writer of the Report: In fact, the one who put an end to the chaos was indeed not a human.
记录者：终结这场混乱的的确不是人类。

Writer of the Report: This "thing" ... I had no idea what it was. It claimed to be a machine which never stops working. It laughed at the limitations of our brains and the metaphysical mistakes we make ceaselessly.
记录者： 它……我不知道它是什么。它宣称自己是一个永不停歇的机器，嘲笑我们受制于大脑的短路，陷入无穷无尽的形而上学错误。

Writer of the Report: But it did solve the most urgent issue: a system was built to tackle "Storm-relevant" emergencies after it took charge of Laplace.
记录者： 但它的确解决了最紧要的问题——在它上任后，一个针对“暴雨”的应急系统被建立起来了。

Writer of the Report: The first measure it adopted was contacting all the existing branches of the Foundation's at the time to confirm the scale of available manpower, then it built observation stations all over the globe to find if there were any other regions immune to the "Storm."
记录者： 第一步就是和当前年代的所有分部取得联系，清算可调配的人力，以及在全球建立观测站点，寻找其它的免疫“暴雨”区域。

Writer of the Report: After that, numerous offices responsible for deducing the cause of the "Storm" were established. Even though there were countless disagreements during the research, at least we had taken the first step.
记录者： 多个推算“暴雨”成因的工作室建立了。尽管人们在理论上争执不休，但总归是迈出了前进的一步。

Writer of the Report: I handed in the application to take part in this mission, determined to get rid of the fog in my mind.
记录者： 我申请了这项任务，基于一种摆脱迷茫的决心。

Writer of the Report: In 1986, I was assigned to the office in Egypt. All my friends came to the dock to see me off ...
记录者： 1986 年我受任前往埃及分部。所有熟识的人都来为我送行。

Writer of the Report: Because we knew it could be the final goodbye ... Even though we were equipped with the emergency communication devices issued by Laplace, we were still not clear when the "Storm" would assault us or where we could hide nearby.
记录者： 我们知道，此行可能是诀别。尽管科算中心配发了应急通讯装置，但我们仍无从知晓“暴雨”何时会来，附近又是否有避难点。

Writer of the Report: What really scared me was not the threat to my life, but the possibility of dying ignorant.
记录者： 我并不畏惧牺牲。我害怕的是一无所知地死去。

Writer of the Report: Then I boarded the ship to Alexandria from Athens, and that was when I met "her."
记录者： 而就在那艘从雅典去往亚历山大港的轮渡上……我遇到了“她”。

Writer of the Report: Now when I recall it, it was almost impossible to ignore that group of arcanists on the ship.
记录者： 想在那艘轮渡上注意不到这个神秘学家团体是非常困难的。

Writer of the Report: There were about a dozen of them, all in eccentric-stitch robes. They were followers of a strange school which mixes arcanum and mathematics.
记录者： 他们大约有十来人，穿着古怪的拼接长袍，信奉一种神秘主义和数学混合的奇特教义。

Writer of the Report: I talked to them. No matter how much that conversation bewilders me now, I was more excited than confused at the time.
记录者： 和他们的交谈让我深感迷惑。但在当时，我的首要感受是振奋。

Writer of the Report: They also survived the "Storm" in 1996, and they noticed the unusual changes taking place in the world as well.
记录者：他们同样躲过了 1996 年的“暴雨”，注意到了世界的异变。

Writer of the Report: That means I actually met another group of survivors from the millennium.
记录者：——我遇到了另一帮来自千禧年的时间遗民。

She stops turning the pages.
翻页的手指戛然停下。

Matilda: Wait, wait.
玛蒂尔达：……等一下，等一下。

Matilda: A school of arcanists who survived the "Storm"?
玛蒂尔达：一个能躲过“暴雨”的神秘学家团体?

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

通天之塔
Tower of Babel 5SP-03

Tower of Babel
通天之塔

Matilda: A mixture of arcanum and mathematics, the ship on the Mediterranean ...
玛蒂尔达：神秘主义和数学混合……地中海的轮渡……

Matilda: Unbelievable! Our investigator actually met this group of arcanists who believed in numbers and even left such a precious record down on paper.
玛蒂尔达：真不可思议……居然真的有调查员遇上了那个信仰数字的神秘学家团体，还留下了珍贵的文字资料。

Sotheby: Does it mean we are close to being helpful to Vertin?!
苏芙比：这也就是说，我们离帮到维尔汀不远了吗?!

The chief assistant of the monitor assistant lets out a cheer.
纪律辅员的第一助手发出欢呼。

Matilda: Certainly. It's what we deserve for all the efforts today! Hmm. But, why did they leave such an important report in the reference room storing "unnecessary information"?
玛蒂尔达：那是当然，这是我们今天辛劳应得的回报！……可是，这么重要的记录为什么会被遗弃在“非必要信息”资料室呢?

Matilda: Did they misput it here after the chaos of the "Storm"?
玛蒂尔达：是在“暴雨”后的混乱中误放了吗?

Putting her confusion aside, Matilda turns to the next page of the record.
间章笔记：玛蒂尔达收起困惑，翻开记录的下一页。

Writer of the Report: Among them, the most easygoing one was Hugh.
记录者：这里面最好相处的人是休。

Writer of the Report: He was an engineer as well as an arcanist. We shared the same preference for human technology, and that became our common topic.
记录者：他是一名神秘学家出身的工程师。对人类科技的偏爱多少让我们有了些共同话题。

Writer of the Report: Hugh was in his 30s, red-haired, cheeks sunken, and deeply depressed due to some kind of eye disease.
记录者：休三十来岁，红头发，脸颊凹陷，因罹患眼疾而深感忧郁。

Writer of the Report: He was a decent man with a prudent attitude, working at a desk most of the time. He reminded me of the imperial miniature painting artists in the Sultan's palace. Most of them ended up blind after toiling for their life.
记录者：他为人严谨正直，总是伏案工作。让我想到苏丹宫廷里的细密画大师，因为一生辛劳最终双目失明。

Writer of the Report: He showed me the picture of his daughter. I don't have children, but I could feel his happiness as a father.
记录者：他给我看了他女儿的照片……虽然我没有子女，但能感受到他为人父母的喜悦。

Writer of the Report: Although I got along well with Hugh, he seemed quite out of place among that group ...
记录者：在这个团体里，休反而是最格格不入的那个。

Writer of the Report: ... which was actually led by "her."
记录者：他们实质上的领头人是“她”。

Writer of the Report: I don't know what words to use to describe "her." She was like a meteor shower, a tempest, or an unreasonable catastrophe itself. Her existence was just like her name: it was simple, yet implied a lot.
记录者：我不知道该如何形容……她就像陨星，飓风，一场不可理喻的天灾本身。就像她的名字一样，简单，却蕴含甚多。

Writer of the Report: Please forgive me for my cowardice. Even now, I don't have the courage to write down her name—if one would call that a name.
记录者：请原谅我的软弱。时至今日，我依然不想写下她的名字——如果那可以称为名字。

Writer of the Report: In fact, she was quite a kind, warmhearted person. Among all the unregistered arcanists I've met, she was one of the nicest ones towards the Foundation.
记录者：实际上，“她”很亲切，相当热情，在我接触的所有未登记神秘学家里，对基金会是相当友好的一个。

Writer of the Report: She looked young, even though I heard she had a daughter, too. Besides, she still possessed the innocence of a child, and that kind of excitement exclusive for genius. That's right. It seemed the whole world was like a sparkling toy to her.
记录者：她看起来很年轻，尽管我听说她也有女儿。她保持了孩童的那种纯真，我所熟悉的属于天才的眼神——整个世界在她看来就像一个闪闪发光的玩具。

Writer of the Report: Our communication was heart-stirring at the beginning.
记录者：最开始，交流还是令人振奋的。

Writer of the Report: Both of us were eager to find out what was happening, like two shipwreck victims grappling at each other on the sea.
记录者：我们都渴望弄清这里发生了什么……就像两个海上漂流的难民牢牢地握住彼此。

Writer of the Report: But I didn't have the slightest idea what she was talking about, actually.
记录者：但事实上我完全不懂她在说什么。

Writer of the Report: The problem was not the typical communication issues between humans and arcanists.
记录者：这不是那种人类和神秘学家无法沟通的问题。

Writer of the Report: I was sure the language we used didn't pose any obstacles, but still, I couldn't understand any words of hers.
记录者：我确信我们的语言并无实质障碍。但我不理解她所用的每一个词。

Writer of the Report: I would believe that one is highly intelligent if one can name all the factors of 11,567 without thinking.
记录者：倘若一个人能在瞬间说出 11567 的所有因数，那我理应相信她拥有很高的智力。

Writer of the Report: But, what this one said was illogical nonsense which no one could ever imagine.
记录者：可我听见的却是一番莫名其妙，不清不楚，毫无逻辑的空话！

Writer of the Report: She claimed that there is a world of numbers "above all else," where the non-physical Essences of all things exist in the form of timeless, absolute, unchangeable ideas, and that the physical world where the time flows is nothing but an "appendage," which has never been real or true.
记录者：她宣称存在一个至高无上的数字天国，在那里万物的本质以抽象的形式永恒存在。而具有时间的物理世界不过是附属的次等品，从未完全真实过。

Writer of the Report: And that's why the chaos in this world is not worth any attention, and we should focus on what happened to the "supreme existence."
记录者：因此眼下世界的混乱是无足轻重的，重要的是弄清“至高存在”发生了什么事。

Writer of the Report: What an utter disaster combining modern maths with ancient superstition! I saw another hubristic arcanist pretending to be the prophet by reliving Platonism.
记录者：这完全是现代数学和古代迷信的灾难结合，柏拉图主义起尸回魂的梦呓，又一个自诩先知的狂妄神秘学家……

Writer of the Report: I don't even bother to mention the balderdash on "soul numbers." Even the New Age Movement could use some of her absurdity.
记录者：更别提那些关于“灵魂数字”的命理鬼话……整个新纪元运动都产生不了这么多胡言乱语。

Writer of the Report: But that was not yet the end. She even claimed to be aware of the exact year when the next reverse would happen!
记录者：她竟然还声称自己已知晓了下一个倒退的年份！

Writer of the Report: But when I asked her about it seriously, she said ...
记录者：可当我认真询问时，她又说：

"HER": "My apologies. I've made an oath. I shall and only shall reveal the demonstration to people who have their own soul numbers."
“她”：“噢，抱歉，我发过誓，不能把证明告诉灵魂没有数字的人。”

Writer of the Report: I'm not sure whether she was making fun of me or being serious, but I had this feeling that she was eager to tell me how she was granted the secret through a moment of afflatus.
记录者：……我不知道她是存心戏弄我，还是来真的。可她好像真的很想告诉我，她是如何灵光一闪，就此知晓了那天赐的奥秘……

Writer of the Report: It seemed she just saw through the laws behind all things instead of finding them through logical deduction.
记录者：在她那里，一切规律似乎是直观地被她洞悉，而不是基于逻辑的推演。

"HER": "Can't you see it? It is right in front of you!"
“她”：“你难道看不见吗？它就在你眼前！”

Writer of the Report: After I expressed my inability to comprehend her words 30 times, she finally gave up and proffered regrets. I'd rather take it as a new kind of humiliation.
记录者：在我第三十次表达不能理解后，她深感遗憾。我倒宁愿这是一种新型羞辱……

Writer of the Report: What really irritated me about her, however, was her contempt towards science and all the scientific research methods.
记录者：但真正激怒我的是她对科学和实验方法的蔑视。

Writer of the Report: As far as I'm concerned, the value of a theory lies in its reliability, universality, and generalizability.
记录者：在我看来，一个理论最重要的是真实可信，具备普遍性和可推广性。

Writer of the Report: Our pursuit of the "truth" has laid the foundation of modern science, allowing us to change the world.
记录者：这份“真”正是近代科学的基础，通过它，我们得以改造世界。

Writer of the Report: Yet, in her eyes, the value of a theory lies in its "beauty."
记录者：而在她看来，最重要的是它够不够“美”。

Writer of the Report: I talked to her on the current situation, and I told her how we would save lives and preserve the hard-earned technology of mankind, if we could find the pattern of the "Storm."
记录者：我和她谈论现状，倘若我们能找到“暴雨”的规律，就能帮助更多人越过雨幕，保存珍贵的科技和文化。

Writer of the Report: It was, of course, not an easy thing to do and would take enormous manpower, so I asked her sincerely to join the Foundation.
记录者：这并非易事，需要大量的人力。因此我也真挚地邀请他们加入。

Writer of the Report: Yet again, she responded with contempt. She believed they would only become another military squad of the Foundation's.
记录者：而她则对此嗤之以鼻。她怀疑这最多是帮助基金会扩张一支军队……

"HER": "Darling, maths is beautiful for its uselessness."
“她”：“亲爱的，纯粹的数学之所以美丽，就在于它一点用也没有。”

"HER": "That's why it remains noble and graceful in this sordid world, despite you humans' reckless action of using it to calculate ballistic."
“她”：“因此它才能在这个肮脏的世界上保持高洁，尽管你们人类还是会把它拿去计算弹道。”

Writer of the Report: She turned down my invitation and left an unfairly negative comment on our "Storm" Observation Project.
记录者：她拒绝了合作邀请，并对我们的“暴雨”观测计划大加贬低。

"HER": "The observation stations you built are destined to be toppled, because their basis is the fragile world that follows the laws of physics. The efforts you've made are like nails on a sand beach, which will only be carried away by the next tidal wave."
“她”：“你们的观测站必将迎来失败！因为它仰赖的是脆弱的物理世界。你们的努力就像是在沙滩上钉下钉子——它只会随着下一次海潮的冲刷毁灭。”

Writer of the Report: But I said, "Perhaps our efforts are in vain, but someone has to do it. We will try every corner of the beach before making the conclusion that the world we're living in is already a hopeless ruin."
记录者：当时，我回答：“也许这是沙上砌塔的无用功。可是总需要有人去做。在每一个沙滩上的角落都被遍历前，谁也不能断言我们脚下的世界已经是无可救药的废墟。”

"HER": "Heh heh ... What a pragmatic, rigorous, and rational speech! But dear, the world is a hopeless ruin!"
“她”：“哈哈哈，多么严谨、务实、理性的发言！可是亲爱的，这个世界就是废墟呀！”

Writer of the Report: The conversation ended in disagreement. I don't know why arcanists hate the world so much. Perhaps the reason is they have never been truly accepted. To this day, I still remember her venomous conclusion ...
记录者：谈话无果而终。我不知道神秘学家对世界的仇恨来自何处，也许因为他们从未被这个世界接纳。我仍记得她恶毒地断言：

"HER": "The world built on past experiences has ended. In your words, which you used to mock us, why not embrace the reality?"
“她”：“你们人类赖以为生的经验世界已经终结了。用你们最爱讥讽我们的话来说——为什么不接受现实呢?”

Writer of the Report: Yet, about the Gnosis which she deeply believed in and the so-called prophecy she made through numbers, she had never given any proofs or details that showed rigorous logic.
记录者：可是，对于她所深信的灵知，那些用数字发布的预言，她也从未给出过任何有严格逻辑的证明细节。

Writer of the Report: And the reason for her inaction was ... was an oath she had made before some stone!
记录者：理由，理由竟是因为她在某块石头前发了禁言的誓……！

Writer of the Report: Therefore, I believed her words were only the nonsense of a lunatic. When we first met, I thought she was different from all those psychos, who mistook the malfunction of their prefrontal cortex as the will of God, but they turned out to be the same.
记录者：所以这里只是一堆神棍的疯言疯语。我本以为她会有别于那些将前额叶的错乱误认为神意的疯子，结果还是如此。

Writer of the Report: In the name of human sense, I swore everything she said was absurd and ridiculous to me, until ...
记录者：我以人类的理智起誓，我坚信这一切纯属荒谬。直到……

Matilda: Hmm. Madam Z said the arcanists on that island are all named after numbers, because they have a strong belief that numbers are the Essence of their souls.
玛蒂尔达：唔，记得 Z 女士说过，那个岛上神秘学家的名字都是数字，因为他们笃信这是一个人的本质。

Matilda: The investigator wouldn't write down "her" name. Is it because of the conflict between their beliefs?
玛蒂尔达：记录者不愿意说出“她”的名字，是因为信仰上的冲突吗?

Matilda turns to the next page eagerly, as if checking a novel brought in class by some undisciplined student.
玛蒂尔达迫不及待地翻到下一页，就像是在检查在校生违规带入课堂的小说。

But the reality welcomes her with an empty page.
现实却让她的期待落了空。

Matilda: Hmm? That's all?!
玛蒂尔达：……咦，这就是最后一页了?!

Maybe because the story ends with an abrupt stop or the hope just raised has dashed down, Matilda clenches her handkerchief with her sweaty palm.
兴许是戛然而止的冒险故事，又或是白白落了一场空的欣喜，令纪律辅员焦急地攥紧了手帕。

Matilda: Submitting such an unfinished report will only cause problems for the reviewers and evaluators! But this investigator didn't even write down their name ...
玛蒂尔达：贸然提交中断在一半的报告，只会造成审理和评估的困难！可这个记录者甚至没有留下自己的名字……

Sotheby: Don't worry, Ms. Bouanich. I'm familiar with this situation. Every time, after the brave Typhon defeats Jupiter, he returns to the Auto Island.
苏芙比：别担心，玛蒂尔达小姐，我经常遇见这种问题。勇敢的提丰赶走朱庇特之后，它便会回到自动小岛……

Sotheby: But, each time we twist the ear of Mr. Glass Box, Typhon will show up again and again!
苏芙比：但只要我们扭动玻璃匣子先生的耳廓，提丰就会一次又一次地跑出来。

Sotheby: Ms. Moissan told me, the ear is the key to bringing back our hope!
苏芙比：莫桑老师说过，它是开启希望的门阀～！

Matilda: Wait, don't tell me you are talking about the shows on the mechanical television ...
玛蒂尔达：等等，你说的该不会是机械扫描电视上的动画片吧……？

Ignoring the monitor assistant's confusion, the enthusiastic young lady starts looking around for the ear that carries all her hope.
罔顾纪律辅员的疑惑，热情的小淑女开始左顾右盼，似乎在寻找着那只寄寓希望的耳廓。

Matilda: Stop, stop, Ms. Sotheby. Please take a seat on the cushion and listen to me carefully.
玛蒂尔达：……苏芙比小姐，请先停止你的行为。接着，请端坐在软垫上，听我说。

Matilda: This is a detailed report written by a formal investigator of the Foundation's, not some TV show full of cliffhangers. That means, we will definitely find the rest somewhere.
玛蒂尔达：这是一份详尽的、由正式的基金会调查员写下的记录。它绝不是故意吊人胃口的电视节目，所以，我们一定能在别的什么地方找到它的其余部分！

Sotheby: Oh, I see! Must be a Cocoa Treant who took away the other part of the book!
苏芙比：噢！苏芙比知道了！一定是一只可可树精叼走了典籍的下半部分！

Sotheby: Usually, they will be attracted by luna fixa. And by following their traces, we'll find their lairs in the stable.
苏芙比：通常只要用少量的固银引诱，就能在马厩发现被它埋起来的巢穴……

Matilda: You mean someone took it away? Hmm, that's highly possible. Data loss is not allowed in the Foundation, especially under the monitor assistant's management.
玛蒂尔达：你是说有人把它拿走了吗？很有可能，毕竟基金会不应发生这种资料遗失问题——尤其是在纪律辅员的管辖范围之内。

Sotheby: We must prepare luna fixa. Don't forget their favourite Jigging Magical Beans!
苏芙比：那我们得赶紧准备固银，还有可可树精最爱的蹦蹦跳跳魔力弹豆！

Sotheby: Hmm. I don't have those materials with me right now, but I can write to them. It only takes a month!
苏芙比：唔，苏芙比现在没有携带这么多材料，但我可以写信……只要静静等待一个月就好！

The disconcerting conversation is clearly too much for this rigorous monitor assistant.
这番跳跃的对话着实使严谨的纪律辅员有些难以忍受。

Matilda: Nuh-uh, we don't need that!
玛蒂尔达：……不，我们不需要那些！

After taking a deep breath, Matilda takes out her crystal orb.
玛蒂尔达深呼吸一口气，坚定地掏出自己的水晶球。

An ambitious smile spreads over her face.
她的脸上出现了志在必得的笑容。

Matilda: You've perfectly accomplished the task from me when you found this valuable report. Well done, Assistant Sotheby.
玛蒂尔达：做得好，苏芙比助手。你找到了这份珍贵的文件，已经圆满且出色地完成了我分配给你的任务。

Matilda: Now it's time for the Great Matilda to show a little bit of her greatness!
玛蒂尔达：现在只需要伟大的玛蒂尔达……稍稍出面！

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

白日航船
Divination in the Day 5SP-04

Divination in the Day
白日航船

Laplace Scientific Computing Center
拉普拉斯科算中心

There is no moonlight during the daytime.
白天当然没有月光。

But the moon is not the only choice for divination.
但谁说占卜不能咨询太阳?

Matilda: Hmm, judging from the omen, it's at "the northwest, the beginning and the ending of the ring, where the wall reflects repeatedly."
玛蒂尔达：唔，从预兆来看，是在西北方位，圆环的起始与终结，墙壁来回反射之处……

Holding the crystal orb with both hands, Matilda keeps adjusting her position while trying to figure out the vague vision in the sphere.
玛蒂尔达小心地捧着水晶球，试图解读里面模糊不清的光景。

Sotheby follows her with a curious face.
苏芙比好奇地跟在她身后。

Matilda: "The northwest" of SPDM, this one is straightforward.
玛蒂尔达：第一防线学校的西北方位，这个很好解读。

Matilda: "The beginning and the ending of the ring" is not a problem, either. The icon of the Computing Center is exactly the Ouroboros, a serpent eating its own tail. Here we are.
玛蒂尔达：“圆环的起始与终结”也并不困难，科算中心的标志正是乌洛波洛斯【Ouroboros】，衔着自己尾巴的蛇——我们已经来到了这里。

Matilda: But, "where the wall reflects repeatedly" ... Does that mean a closed room with mirrors?
玛蒂尔达：可是，来回反射的墙壁……是指有镜子的封闭房间吗?

Matilda: The mirror in the Display Center is a huge kinescope in the wall, and the one in the Airtight Laboratory is a crystal-clear observation window.
玛蒂尔达：显影中心的镜子是一面巨大的光学显像管墙壁，气密实验室的镜子是一块锃亮的观察窗……

Matilda: The one in the rehab center? No no no. The mirrors in the operation room have been replaced with curved electronic screens of steel structure after that Zeno pilot made a scene.
玛蒂尔达：康复中心的镜子就更不可能了。多亏了那位芝诺飞行员的大出风头，手术室的镜子被统一替换成了曲面钢结构的电子屏幕……

Matilda: So, where is the answer?
玛蒂尔达：……答案究竟在哪儿呢?

She slowly turns around, trying to find the perfect angle for a clearer vision.
玛蒂尔达转了个圈，试图让水晶球的显影变得更清晰一点。

A white figure storms away from her side, almost bumping off the orb she tightly holds.
一阵银白的疾风掠过她的身侧，差点让水晶球打落在地。

Matilda: Hey! You just hit me. Shouldn't you apologize?
玛蒂尔达：——嘿，你撞到人都不道歉的吗?

Researcher: Ah ...!
研究员：……啊?

Researcher: Where did you come from, dork? Wasting my time!
研究员：真狗屎，哪来的呆瓜？没空和你说话……!

The man groans a curse and hastily leaves this place with his hands covering his nose and mouth.
险些撞到玛蒂尔达的男人只是咒骂一声，便捂着口鼻，急匆匆地离开了。

Matilda: What?! How could he say that? That's rude!
玛蒂尔达：什么？他怎么能这样说，没礼貌的家伙!

Sotheby: That gentleman doesn't look well. He's covering his face. His nose is running with purple liquid. Oh, dear! Did he drink a whole bottle of purple crossandra juice?!
苏芙比：那位先生的脸色很不好……他捂着鼻子，还流着深紫色的鼻涕……天啊，难道他喝了一整瓶紫雀尾花汁吗?!

Sotheby: He needs treatment immediately! Oh! If only I had brought the phoenix heart nerves with me ...
苏芙比：他需要立刻解毒！唉，如果苏芙比出门的时候带上了凤凰的心肝神经就好了……

Matilda: He ran towards the rehab center. Humph! Nothing to worry about. Just another patient trying to prove he has recovered.
玛蒂尔达：他朝着康复中心的方向跑掉了。哈啊，没什么可担心的，只是又一个试图证明自己已经恢复健康的病人。

The hasty man has disappeared completely. The little incident doesn't raise anyone's attention.
慌忙的人影早已消失得无影无踪，似乎没有任何人注意到这儿的风波。

Matilda: The rehab center has all the facilities and medicines he needs. He will be properly treated. But why is he wearing the uniform of Laplace?
玛蒂尔达：康复中心拥有完善的医疗设施与药品，他会得到妥善、科学的治疗……不过，他为什么穿着科算中心的制服呢?

Matilda: Hmm, and where's the receptionist here?
玛蒂尔达：而且……平时在这儿的接待员呢?

The lobby of the Scientific Computing Center welcomes them with a deafening silence.
科算中心的大厅里寂静无声。

The counter is no longer busy with people but with an auto-recognition device instead.
往日繁忙的前台不见人影，只有自动认证装置在闪着银色的光。

Sotheby: Does everyone go to the weekend party night?
苏芙比：大家是去参加周末派对夜了吗?

Probing around the counter, the temporary investigator seems determined to dig out a party gramophone from somewhere.
临时的调查员好奇地探头探脑，似乎打定主意要在某个角落找出一台派对留声机。

Matilda: Absolutely not. The researchers here are too busy to do that!
玛蒂尔达：这儿的研究员可没有那种闲情雅致！

Matilda: The Computing Center is working on the most urgent and vital project—the research on the immunity to the "Storm." We should not disturb them unless it's an emergency.
玛蒂尔达：科算中心正在开展眼下最重要、最紧急的工作，免疫“暴雨”的研究——如果不是特别要紧的事，我们不应叨扰。

Matilda: So, please stop calling the office and put down the telephone, Ms. Sotheby. This is not the ear of a Teakettler, and it won't take you to any twist balls!
玛蒂尔达：……所以，请马上放下你手上的内线电话，苏芙比小姐。这绝不是提科特勒的耳朵，提着它也不会带你去扭扭舞会！

The monitor assistant can't stand the difference in their terminology anymore.
连番发生的鸡同鸭讲显著消耗了纪律辅员的耐心。

Matilda: &$#% ... I know she's a rookie, but even so, she's way too unbelievable!
玛蒂尔达：＆￥#%……即便是刚刚入行的新人，她未免也太难以理解了吧?

Matilda: "Guide new members with caution and patience. Trigger their afflatus at the right time." Oh, I have to admit, Vertin is doing it better than me for now.
玛蒂尔达：“审慎、耐心地引导，以促使新人在重要时刻涌现出惊人的灵光一现。”
……呜，我承认，维尔汀在这一项上取得了暂时的胜利……

Her mumbling is interrupted by the owner of the cheerful footsteps.
欢欣的足步声回到玛蒂尔达的身后，打断了她的小声嘀咕。

Sotheby: Ms. Bouanich, I just read the map on the counter.
苏芙比：布翁尼小姐，我刚刚研究了一下前台放着的这份地图。

Sotheby: You mentioned "where the wall reflects repeatedly." Does the vision refer to the Racket Ball Center here? You see, its icon is a bouncing ball.
苏芙比：“来回反射的墙壁”，指的是不是这个……壁球活动中心呀？你瞧，它的图标正是一颗反弹的球……

Matilda: ...!
玛蒂尔达：……！

Matilda: Let me take a look!
玛蒂尔达：快让我看看！

Matilda: Found it. This is really the right direction!
玛蒂尔达：有了，果然这个方向是对的！

Matilda: Next, "empty boxes, glassware, and copper pieces." Hmm. Looks like our destination has piles of metal.
玛蒂尔达：接下来是空箱子、玻璃皿和碎铜。看来我们最终的目的地里堆着许多金属……

The vision in the orb is growing clearer, proving that they're heading in the right direction.
水晶球上的预兆愈发清晰，这昭示着她们正走在正确的方向上。

That eases Matilda's upset mind.
纪律辅员的心情也随之大好。

Matilda: Ahem ... good job, Assistant Sotheby.
玛蒂尔达：……咳，做得不错，苏芙比助理。

Matilda: I have to say, I might have gone a bit too hard on you. You are more capable than I thought. Thanks to your prompt reminder, we have saved quite some time.
玛蒂尔达：我承认，我先前对你也许苛刻了一点……但多亏了你及时的情报，我们才没有浪费太多时间。

Sotheby: Sotheby is glad to help!
苏芙比：苏芙比很高兴能帮上忙！

The young lady gladly hops along the way, while she doesn't give up peering at Matilda's crystal orb.
小淑女在一旁蹦蹦跳跳，目光始终好奇地停留在玛蒂尔达的水晶球上。

Sotheby: Ms. Bouanich, since you're such a talented diviner ...
苏芙比：布翁尼小姐，既然基金会有你这样厉害的占卜师……

Sotheby: Why don't you just divine the reason for the "Storm" with your inherited arcanum ability?
苏芙比：那你不能通过你所继承的神秘学能力，直接占卜出“暴雨”的成因吗?

Sotheby: According to Ms. Moissan, the reason still remains a mystery. If the crystal orb can reveal its truth, everything will be much easier for Vertin and her team!
苏芙比：我听莫桑老师说，这至今是一个无人知晓的谜。如果水晶球能告诉我们原因的话，那维尔汀他们应该就会轻松许多了！

Matilda: D-Divine the reason for the "Storm"?!
玛蒂尔达：占，占卜“暴雨”?!

The brave assumption astonishes this great diviner. She almost drops the orb.
意想不到的名词令大占卜师一个趔趄，险些将水晶球失手打落。

Matilda: That's IMPOSSIBLE, for sure!
玛蒂尔达：那当然是不可能的——！

Matilda: It's a typical mistake of layman's to believe one can see everything through divination!
玛蒂尔达：认为占卜是万能的，是外行人才会犯的常见错误！

Matilda: You are an expert on potions and arcane creatures, but you have little knowledge on other subjects. Haven't you received any systematic education on arcanum?
玛蒂尔达：明明你在魔药学和神秘动物学上十分精通，这些地方却一点也不懂……难道你没有接受过系统的神秘学体系教育吗?

Sotheby: Education on arcanum? I'm, of course, well-educated in arcanum, with Ms. Moissan as my tutor, and my arcane friends such as Typhon from the Auto Island, Jupiter, and ...
苏芙比：神秘学教育？苏芙比当然受到了良好的教育，有莫桑女士、自动小岛的提丰、朱庇特，还有……

Matilda: ... Alright, alright, enough.
玛蒂尔达：……好了，停下，停下。

She shakes her head, stopping her from listing another name for an arcane creature that nobody has ever heard of.
玛蒂尔达摇摇头，阻止了苏芙比再说出一个无人听闻的神秘动物的学名。

Matilda: I have understood the fact that the education you have received is not systematical ... or, say, incomplete, imperfect, inelegant!
玛蒂尔达：我已经理解了，你所接受的教育是不完整的——或者说是，不够健全、完美、优雅的！

Matilda: Humph ... But don't worry, because you are talking to the kindhearted Matilda! She will spend her valuable time to make it up for you.
玛蒂尔达：哼……还好你遇到了好心的玛蒂尔达！愿意抽出自己宝贵的时间，给你补上这珍贵的一课。

The great monitor assistant clears her throat and starts recalling what she learned when she was 12.
了不起的协助教员清了清喉咙，开始回忆自己十二岁课堂上的内容。

Matilda: In fact, the system of arcanum knowledge is not completely separated from that of human science. For example, the modern pharmacy and chemistry actually originated from the experiments of potions and alchemy in the ancient times.
玛蒂尔达：在神秘学家所研习的知识里，有一些和人类的科学是交叉的。譬如魔药学和炼金术的实验部分，它们本身也是现代药学和化学的古老前身。

Matilda: They developed into two different systems because arcanists focused more on the knowledge ignored by scientists, which is Gnosis.
玛蒂尔达：但神秘学家更注重的是另一进路的知识，也就是灵知。

Matilda: The "knowledge" we learn from divination is exactly under this category.
玛蒂尔达：占卜获取的“知识”，就属于这一种。

Sotheby: Wow ...
苏芙比：哇……

Sotheby's eyes light up with amazement.
苏芙比的眼睛兴奋地睁大了。

Matilda takes out her notebook and draws a brief sketch in it.
玛蒂尔达掏出笔记本，有模有样地在上面勾勒了几笔。

Matilda: Let me fill you in with more details. If two human researchers test Snell's Law at two different places at the same time without making any mistakes, they will always reach the same conclusion.
玛蒂尔达：比方说，有两个人类的研究员，同时在两个地点检验斯涅尔折射定律，他们最后总是能得到趋于一致的结果。

Matilda: Or, if two potionists use the same ingredients and follow the same formula to make the Cough Cough Stop Stop Potion separately, their products will also have similar effects.
玛蒂尔达：或者，有两个魔药学家，同时使用了相同的材料和配方，那他们也能制造出功效相近的咳咳立止剂。

Matilda: However, if two diviners respectively perform divination on the same thing, they will probably see totally different "visions."
玛蒂尔达：但如果有两个占卜师，同时对一件事做出了占卜，他们看到的“画面”可能会大相径庭。

Matilda: Because what the divination shows is merely "omens." The interpretation of these omens is in fact a kind of subjective deduction based on the reality, and there is no such thing as a standard answer.
玛蒂尔达：因为占卜揭示的只是“预兆”，对它的解读，本质是基于现行一切的推演，不存在标准答案。

Matilda: Even if the two diviners draw the same conclusion, it is more of a coincidence than a result that implies generalizability. So, diviners never check the accuracy of their divination through the review of peers!
玛蒂尔达：即使这两个占卜师碰巧给出了差不多的结论，它也不具备推广性。所以，从来没有占卜师会通过同行评议来验证自己是否正确！

Matilda: And this is an example of Gnosis. Unlike human sense, it is unique and possesses no universality.
玛蒂尔达：这就是灵知，它独一无二，也无法像理性一样放之四海而皆准。

She puts it away and wiggles her index finger.
玛蒂尔达收起笔记本，对苏芙比晃了晃手指。

Matilda: In other words, even if someone finds out a reason for the "Storm" through divination, they can't have other diviners verify it, because a hundred different diviners will give out a hundred different conclusions. The scene will be even busier than a concert at Musikverein.
玛蒂尔达：换而言之，即便有人占卜出了“暴雨”的原因，也无法只靠占卜来检验结论！一百个占卜师会得出一百个结论，场面会比金色大厅的交响乐团还要热闹十倍。

Matilda: That being said, the more possible result we get from the divination is nothing! Divination cannot bring knowledge which the diviners have never learned. The divination of such world-class knowledge as complicated as the reason for the "Storm" can only be performed by world-class diviners.
玛蒂尔达：更实际的情况是，根本就占卜不出来！因为占卜者无法获得超越自己能力的知识。要做这种世界级别的占卜，必须也是世界级别的占卜家才行。

Matilda: We may find one or two diviners like that if time continues to be reversed, like Nostradamus, hmm, but he lived in the 16th century.
玛蒂尔达：如果“暴雨”持续回退，也许还能遇到这样优秀的占卜家。就像诺查丹玛斯……可他都是16 世纪的人物了。

Matilda: Besides, even Nostradamus is not always right.
玛蒂尔达：而且，即使是他，也不总是正确的。

Sotheby: But ... but Ms. Bouanich is!
苏芙比：可是——可是，布翁尼小姐的占卜总是正确的！

Sotheby: Thanks to your divination, we're getting closer and closer to that report, right?
苏芙比：我们现在不就在逐渐靠近那本记录么？

Matilda: ...!
玛蒂尔达：……！

Matilda: Y-You, you ... you are right! Finding items, interpreting dreams, and making simple prophecies ... All these things are just a breeze for the bright and clever Matilda!
玛蒂尔达：你，你你……你说得没错！寻物，释梦，简单的预言，聪明伶俐的玛蒂尔达当然不在话下！

Matilda: But inquiring about the "Storm" is beyond my ability, and it will only bring misfortune. Humph! I will never make such a stupid mistake!
玛蒂尔达：而贸然询问超出自己能力的事，只会招致灾祸——我才不会犯下这种愚蠢的错误！

Matilda regains her radiant appearance.
玛蒂尔达又恢复了意气风发的神色。

Matilda: In fact, this half of the report and the handwriting of the author are perfect divination media.
玛蒂尔达：实际上，我们拥有这部手稿的上半，拥有作者的亲笔，这些都是很好的媒介材料。

Matilda: Besides, our target is not far away from us, and I'm familiar with the surroundings, which have made things much easier than usual.
玛蒂尔达：它实际距离我们并不遥远，我对于当下环境也很熟悉，这也大大降低了占卜的难度。

Matilda: It is true diviners can improve the accuracy and controllability of their Gnosis by practicing repeatedly, holding the rituals properly, and making targeted preparations ... but that still doesn't mean the result will be absolutely accurate.
玛蒂尔达：通过反复的练习、正确的仪式、合适的准备，也能够提高“灵知”的准确度和可控性……但它依然不是绝对的。

Sotheby nods. No one can tell from her face whether she truly understands that announcement or not.
苏芙比似懂非懂地点了点头。

Reading the vision in the orb, Matilda leads Sotheby around another corner nimbly.
玛蒂尔达一面解读着水晶球的预兆，灵巧地带她再次转过一个弯。

Sotheby: The report says, that person who mentioned the school of numbers claimed she was enlightened about the year of the next "Storm" ...
苏芙比：那本记录里，提到了那个数字教派的人，声称自己得知了下一次“暴雨”回溯的年代……

Sotheby: Is that also by divination?
苏芙比：这也能视为一种占卜么?

Matilda: Hmm, I am not sure what kind of arcane skills they used, but numbers are indeed a kind of omen, too. I am not talking about the specific knowledge of mathematics, but the numbers themselves, because they are even more abstract than images and languages as a kind of symbol ...
玛蒂尔达：唔，我不清楚他们的神秘术。但数字本身也可以作为一种预兆，有别于具体的数学知识。因为它是比图像和语言都更加抽象的符号……

Matilda: Even so, there is no way for us to verify this prophet, unless it really comes true.
玛蒂尔达：但即使真有人做出了这个预言，我们也无法检验——除非它真的应验。

Matilda: That is also why it takes almost nothing to spread a prophecy. My mother told me many people in the outside world write to the Foundation every day, claiming to be prophets who can predict the doomsday and thus requesting unemployment benefits ...
玛蒂尔达：毕竟发布预言的成本实在是太低了。我听妈妈说，在外面的世界，每天都有很多自称末日先知的人写信给基金会办事处，要求通过他们的失业救济补贴……

Sotheby: The doomsday? Unemployment benefits? Oh, my! The outside world is far more wonderful than I thought! How fascinating!
苏芙比：末日先知，失业补贴……天啊，到处都是我不知道的事，外面的世界真是太有意思了!

Sotheby: Ms. Bouanich is even greater than I expected!
苏芙比：布翁尼小姐原来比我想象中的还要伟大!

Matilda: Humph ... you bet!
玛蒂尔达：哼哼，那是当然……

Matilda: W-Wait! D-Did you mean I was not the greatest?
玛蒂尔达：不对，你的意思是原来并不伟大吗?

They have reached the end of the corridor.
走廊已至尽头。

Matilda puts away the orb and looks at a wooden door with no sign in front of her.
玛蒂尔达收回水晶球，在一扇没有门牌的木门前站定。

This is where the vision leads them to—the room next to the Racket Ball Center.
壁球活动中心的隔壁间——这是预兆指示的最终点。

Matilda: Here we are, Ms. Sotheby.
玛蒂尔达：苏芙比小姐，我们到了。

Matilda: Now, this is the moment to verify the result of my divination.
玛蒂尔达：——现在就是检验占卜正确与否的时刻了。

Squeak—
“吱呀——”

She opens the door with a slight push.
她轻轻推开了门。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

小径① 目所能及的雨
Trail① Rain Within Reach 小径

If you look at the ground after the "rain," you can often see a wet, long trail like this one.
???: 只要多看看雨后的地面，您就能发现这道潮湿的、漫长的痕迹。

At the end of the trail, there may be a snail slowly crawling forward. Yes, "forward." The snail marks the direction for us.
???: 在痕迹尽头或许会有一只缓慢爬行的蜗牛，它为我们标识出何为“前方”。

But, what if we don't see any snails at either end? How are we going to distinguish the direction to the future from that to the past?
???: 可——如果没找见蜗牛呢？直线的哪一头才是前，哪一头又指向过去？

选项 / Choices

1. We need a criterion.
1. 需要更多依据

2. Sorry, but I have no idea.
2. 抱歉，我不知道

分支 1 / Branch 1

"Criterion," well said, darling. To figure something out, you always need to make deductions based on facts and logical reasoning.
???: 您听听，依据。凡事都要找点儿道理和实例，进行缜密推演。

What you see is not necessarily true, but what is logical is, because we haven't witnessed or experienced anything illogical so far. If something like that actually happens, it must be because we are too ignorant to understand it for the moment.
???: 眼见并非为实，合逻辑的才是正确的，切实的。因为还尚未有能动摇逻辑规律的东西存在，如果有——那只是缘于不够了解。

This point was firmly believed by those researchers who worked in the house like canned sardines.
???: 曾经那群在罐头房子里忙碌的研究者们是如此认为的。

It remained true to them until the first drop of rain rose. The sardines suddenly found that the knowledge they possessed couldn't support the point anymore. The can was opened, revealing a completely different thinking pattern to them.
???: 直到第一滴雨落下，他们猛然间发觉原有的认知已不足以自洽，就像破掉的窗户上那个巨大的空洞。

Whatever they used to mend the can, there was still a crevice left between the inside and the outside, and it could be ripped open again at any time.
???: 无论如何用木板、铁皮、防水布遮挡和修补，最终，一片狼藉中留下的仍旧只有这么扇摇摇欲坠的窗户。

分支 2 / Branch 2

Oh, you just figured out how those researchers handled matters: face the ignorance and do everything they could to find the answers.
???: 喔！承认尚有不明白的事儿，接着费工夫弄懂它，您已经摸清了那群家伙的行事方式。

When the rain rose, they struggled to collect every component left, hoping to preserve the castle built by science. Unfortunately, the effort was in vain. Another wave washed away the castle and restored it to quicksand.
???: 那群在满地狼藉里费力地捡拾零件，希望尽力保留科技成果的研究者，眼瞅着浪潮将搭建好的沙堡冲刷，最后还原为散碎的沙砾。

Even so, they still worked hard in that house like canned sardines to record what was happening, because they believed at least the can holding them was a safe place. Yet in the end, they found that the can was only another sandcastle on the beach.
???: 他们专注地做着记录，本以为自己所处的地方是个安全坚固的罐头，却发现四壁之中填充的同样是数不清的沙。

Everything they were familiar with disappeared when the first drop of rain rose.
???: 从落下的第一滴雨开始，熟悉的存在消失殆尽。

选项 / Choices

1. What happened then?
1. 然后呢?

The chaos didn't last. If it really was the rain that swept away the snail and messed up time ... then, we should look at the silver lining.
???: 混乱不会持续太久。如果是突如其来的雨冲走了蜗牛，把时间搅得一塌糊涂……那么，反过来想——

Does it mean we will find out the truth of time once the secret of the rain is revealed? There has never been a shortcut like this one, since time is only an intangible concept.
???: 弄清雨的秘密，是否就能洞悉时间？在此前可没有这样好的案例，时间本该是个摸不着、瞧不见的概念。

So then, observation stations were built all over the globe. The staff learned how to collect and keep the valuable samples efficiently in no time. The little boxes they used to store the raindrops are still being upgraded even now.
???: 很快，观测站在世界各地冒了出来。以最快、最实用的方式，他们学会了采集与保存珍贵的研究材料，能盛放雨水的小盒子至今还在持续迭代。

Order and silence were brought back to the labs. Every piece of gear was placed back on the right track.
???: 研究室重归整齐与寂静，每一枚齿轮都回到了原有的轨道。

It was a grand feat, and no one could have accomplished it inside this huge, cumbersome machine except another machine. She took no sides and sought only predictable results.
???: 能迅速了解这座臃肿、庞大、吱吱作响的机器的，终究也是机器。她并不倾向某一方，只追逐看得见的结果。

That's why she made a decision as soon as she read that report and its attachment on her desk. The former was about a delicate component which flapped like a butterfly in that huge machine, and the latter was a piece of paper full of circles and dots.
???: 所以，当那页报告——关于机器中某些忙着扑扇翅膀的，轻巧细小的零件，以及一张布满圈画与墨点的纸张被送到桌面时，她立刻做好了决定。

Then she stored the information on her hard disk and destroyed the report.
???: ——她毁去了报告，只让这些信息留在她的存储硬盘中。

And the paper which claimed to have recorded the locations where the "Storm" might happen—yes, the one with the butterfly-like drawings—was retained for data comparison.
???: 而那张据称是“暴雨”发生地点预测的纸——上面的涂画就像蝴蝶眼斑——被她保存下来，和现有的研究结果进行比对。

She seems satisfied with the result.
???: 看样子结果使她很满意。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Rain Within Reach
目所能及的雨

缄默的悼词
The Lament in Silence 5SP-05

The Lament in Silence
缄默的悼词

???
???

The light is dim here.
光线很昏暗。

Archive cabinets and unorganized files are everywhere, punctuated by strange devices in Laplace style. It seems like an abandoned utility room.
到处都堆满了档案柜和文件，以及拉普拉斯风格的古怪装置，像是一个无人使用的杂物间。

Matilda: *coughs* Where are we? Lost-and-Found of the Racket Ball Center?
玛蒂尔达：咳咳……这里难道是壁球场馆的失物招领处吗?

She waves away the dust and struggles her way along the toppling cabinets.
玛蒂尔达驱赶着空气中的灰尘，在摇摇欲坠的文件柜下艰难行走。

Matilda: Hmm, the orb showed copper pieces. We need to find something that seems to be locked but is actually not.
玛蒂尔达：唔，水晶球里有碎铜的意象……我们要寻找的是看起来上锁，但其实没有上锁的东西。

Matilda: Aha, found it! Nothing can stop the genius Matilda!
玛蒂尔达：……哈，有了！没有什么能难倒天才玛蒂尔达!

She finds what she's looking for in a rusty drawer.
她在一个生锈的抽屉里找到了熟悉的笔迹。

Obviously, the report has been here for a very long time.
而这份记录显然放在这里已经很久了。

Its corners curl because of the damp air. Luckily, the writing is still recognizable.
它的角落早已受潮，卷曲。所幸字迹仍然清晰。

Writer of the Report: ... The trip to Egypt didn't go smoothly.
记录者：……去往埃及分部之行并不顺利。

Writer of the Report: The ship was hit by a common storm at sea. We were lost in the fog after that, completely off course.
记录者：邮轮在中途遭遇了暴风雨，我们迷失在浓雾中，完全偏离了航线。

Writer of the Report: Then something emerged from the water. Since the first "Storm," the Foundation has received frequent sightings of arcane creatures which should have been extinct in history.
记录者：在“暴雨”发生后，世界各地经常出现历史上已经消失的神秘生物的目击报告。

Writer of the Report: I had no idea what I was shooting at, even after I emptied the clip.
记录者：我向水里的那东西射空了所有子弹，也不知道它究竟是什么。

Writer of the Report: And I didn't know what to do. Those arcanists brought us back on course. She named the precise longitude and latitude of our location, even without using the sextant in the spare cabin.
记录者：而将航道带回正轨的是那帮神秘学家。她准确地说出了当前的经纬度，甚至没有启动备用舱里的六分仪。

Writer of the Report: I wonder how she did that. Perhaps the world did look different in her eyes.
记录者：我不知道她是怎么做到的……也许她眼里的世界真的和我眼里的不一样。

Writer of the Report: Then, when I was about to step on a random plank on the ship, she suddenly dragged me back. I thought it was only an inappropriate joke ...
记录者：当我要踏上某块木板时，她突然拽了我一把。我以为这是一个不合时宜的恶作剧……

Writer of the Report: But the next second, the plank broke.
记录者：下一秒，那块木板就碎了。

Writer of the Report: I was stunned and asked her how she saw that coming. She just answered me as if we were talking about the weather ...
记录者：我惊讶于她如何得知。她稀松平常地告诉我：

"HER": "Because that plank is deformed like a rhombus."
“她”：“因为它在菱形的形变处。”

Writer of the Report: I was confused, "Where is the rhombus?" She laughed.
记录者：我十分不解，“请问，哪里有菱形?”于是她笑了。

"HER": "The rhombus can't be seen with eyes. You shall close your eyes, hearken to the teaching of the supreme existence, and seize the moment of afflatus!"
“她”：“您这样是什么都看不到的，得闭上眼睛，用心去聆听那至高存在的启示，捕捉那灵感的一瞬闪光才行!”

Writer of the Report: Of course, I didn't see anything, nor did I understand what a moment of afflatus was. Perhaps it's just another privilege enjoyed by arcanists, just like their right to be lunatic.
记录者：当然，我什么也看不到，也不明白何为灵感的一闪。也许这和发疯一样，是神秘学家的特权。

Writer of the Report: Nevertheless, she reached the correct conclusion in a completely wrong way. Is it really possible?
记录者：——一个人使用的方式是完全错误的，却离奇地抵达了正确的结论。这样的事情有概率发生吗?

Writer of the Report: Anyway, she saved my life, but that was not enough to settle the differences between us.
记录者：……无论如何，她救了我一命。但这很难消除我们之间既有的隔阂。

Writer of the Report: She remained rejective to working with the Foundation, and I finally gave up the attempt to persuade them.
记录者：她拒绝了与基金会的合作，我也放弃了说服他们的尝试。

Writer of the Report: My mission on that trip was not to make contact with them.
记录者：接触他们并非我此行的任务。

Writer of the Report: Besides, what we needed was builders of the "Storm" Observation System, not some liars who would only make things worse.
记录者：何况，我们需要的是能建设“暴雨”观测体系的人才，而不是让场面更加混乱的神棍。

Writer of the Report: As for the shelter they took from the "Storm," she wouldn't say a word, as if she were dealing with a spy who pried to find out the deepest secret of the arcanists.
记录者：对于他们的避难地址——她守口如瓶，似乎笃定我要探听神秘学家的不传之秘。

Writer of the Report: In the end, Hugh mediated between us. He gave me an address in Istanbul to which I could send letters to contact them.
记录者：最后，是休调停了纷争。他给了我一个在伊斯坦布尔的联络地址，告知我可以寄信到那里。

Writer of the Report: After that, I spent more than half a year in the Egypt office. Things were even worse there than I expected.
记录者：我在埃及分部的办事处待了大半年。这里的情况比预想中还要糟糕许多。

Writer of the Report: Some have gone missing after the "Storm": the people who were supposed to be in the Egypt office, according to the member list stored in the headquarters in 1985, were not there when I arrived.
记录者：有一些人在“暴雨”中失踪了——按照总部在 1985 年的名录，他们理应在此刻存在于埃及分部，当地却查无踪迹。

Writer of the Report: The situation could be caused by the limitations of the transmission of paper-based materials, because computer was not yet popularized to every corner of the globe at that time. One minor mistake of a copyist's could develop into a huge difference.
记录者：这可能是纸质资料的滞后性导致的，当时电脑还尚未全球普及。一个抄写员出现纰漏，结果就会失之千里。

Writer of the Report: Besides that, the chaos inside Laplace was an even worse issue.
记录者：更难办的是科算中心内部的混乱。

Writer of the Report: I learned that someone published the paper, Samplings of Global and Regional Chaotic Energy Route Changes, in the name of Butterfly of Lorentz.
记录者：我知道，有人以“洛伦兹蝴蝶”署名发表了《全球环境与局部混沌能量的变化路径采样》。

Writer of the Report: Apparently, they secretly used our sampling sites, yet their research direction and conclusion were radically different from Laplace's.
记录者：很显然，他们借用了我们的采样点，研究方向与结论却和拉普拉斯的大相径庭。

Writer of the Report: The researchers equally divided into two schools: one sticking to the human technology they have focused on, and one changing their direction to arcanum.
记录者：固守人类科技和转向神秘学的研究员们正在分庭抗礼。

Writer of the Report: At the time, it was still too early to decide which direction was right without sufficient experimental data.
记录者：眼下还难以评判谁是正确的，因为缺乏数据验证。

Writer of the Report: But many already believed that if time continued to be reversed, human technology would only keep falling into decline, while arcanum, which relies on personal ability, would rise again.
记录者：但到处都是这样的声音：如果时代持续倒退，人类的科技只会越来越衰落，仰赖个人能力的神秘学却会大放异彩。

Writer of the Report: It's true that Gnosis cannot be copied, verified by an independent third party, or comprehended through reasoning ...
记录者：是的，灵知不可重复，不可独立验证，无法被理性理解……

Writer of the Report: Its nature decides that it cannot lay the foundation of science or be popularized to every ordinary person. It takes solid marble to build a castle, not slippery sand.
记录者：它无法搭建起科学的大厦，也无法推广至所有的人群。就像细软的流沙，与理性的花岗岩的质地相去甚远。

Writer of the Report: Even so, what harm will it do to rely on arcanum when the underlying logic of all things has become unreasonable?
记录者：——可既然整个世界的根基都已经变得不可理喻，那又有什么所谓呢?

Writer of the Report: Before the disagreement was settled, the "Storm" in 1987 was predicted. We were ordered to return to the headquarters 24 hours before its arrival.
记录者：……在争执不休中，1987 年的“暴雨”到来了。我们都接到了提前 24 小时返回总部的通知。

Writer of the Report: But the prediction was not accomplished by Laplace. A captive from Manus Vindictae named the precise date of that "Storm."
记录者：但这并非科算中心的功劳。一个重塑之手的俘虏说出了“暴雨”的准确日期。

Writer of the Report: Our enemy, those lunatic xenophobes valuing only pure blood, made it further than we did.
记录者：我们的敌人——这些纯血种主义的疯子，比我们走得更远。

Writer of the Report: Yes, we built observation stations, we made countless deductions, we developed multiple simulation models ...
记录者：是的，我们搭建了观测站，我们给出了无数推论，我们拟合了多种模型。

Writer of the Report: We made efforts, we sacrificed life, we did whatever we could ...
记录者：我们付出了汗水、牺牲、一切能尽的努力。

Writer of the Report: Yet, the result was that we didn't find any other regions immune to the "Storm" except the headquarters and another one in North America.
记录者：除了总部和北美洲外，我们未能探查到其他大陆免疫回溯的区域。

Writer of the Report: In the end, 95% of the branch members were reversed, 87.9% of the equipment was destroyed, and 100% of our predictions failed.
记录者：95% 的分部成员在“暴雨”中被回溯，87.9% 的设备作废，100% 的预测失败。

Writer of the Report: In conclusion, our endeavor brought no achievements. As for the captive from Manus Vindictae, the delirium patient who claimed that oracles flowed under his parietal bone ...
记录者：我们没有取得任何成果——而那个重塑之手的成员，宣称自己颅顶骨下不断流出神谕的谵妄患者……

Writer of the Report: When we asked him how he learned the precise date of the "Storm," he burst into laughter.
记录者：当我们询问他何以知道“暴雨”的日期时，他只是大笑。

Manus Follower: "Can't you hear it?! Has God left you behind when he spread his grace?!"
重塑追随者：“你们听不见吗?！神忘了眷顾你们了?！”

Writer of the Report: Then, he smashed his own skull with the handcuff.
记录者：然后，他便用手铐砸碎了自己的颅骨。

Writer of the Report: Yes, there was no doubt—he was an incurable lunatic.
记录者：是的，他是一个无药可救的疯子。

Writer of the Report: But his insane nonsense was exactly the reason we survived the "Storm" again! No matter how unreasonable or illogical it was, or how much a lie it sounded like!
记录者：可我们的幸存却切实仰赖这些精神错乱的，疯疯癫癫的胡话！这些违背理智的，不可理喻的神棍式断言！

Writer of the Report: "So, we'd better believe we shouldn't go out in black today because the fish is swimming in the water."
记录者：所以，我们最好开始相信鱼在水里，今天不可穿黑色的衣服出门。

Writer of the Report: "We'd better believe in the existence of the non-physical, everlasting transcendent world where everyone's soul is a number."
记录者：最好相信确实存在永恒超验的抽象天国，在那里每个人的灵魂都是一个数字。

Writer of the Report: "We'd better believe in the supreme existence which caused the disorder of time by merely casting its shadow. "
记录者：我们也最好相信有某种至高无上的伟大存在，时间的震颤只是它投下的一抹阴影。

Writer of the Report: "That means the life of individuals means nothing more than rubbish, and the world is but an imperfect ruin where only the chosen ones will pass the trial while the rest will be eliminated by the rain."
记录者：因此个人的性命是无关紧要的，世界也不过是一个残次的垃圾场。只有蒙拣选者能通过试炼，而庸人只配被雨幕清除。

Writer of the Report: How am I supposed to do that?!
记录者：——我怎么能相信这种事?!

Writer of the Report: Finally, I made up my mind to write to "her."
记录者：我终于下定决心，给“她”写一封信。

Writer of the Report: I didn't expect her to answer my questions. All I wanted was to confirm if she had survived that "Storm."
记录者：我不期望她能彻底解答我的疑惑，仅仅只想要确认她是否躲过了这一次的“暴雨”。

Writer of the Report: For the sake of our peaceful talk about the rhombus.
记录者：至少，我们曾心平气和地谈论过菱形。

Writer of the Report: Yet, what I heard from them was a simple announcement of her death with only two words.
记录者：可我收到的却是一封言简意赅的讣告。

Letter: "She died."
信：“她死了。”

Writer of the Report: Then it burned and turned to ashes in a second.
记录者：随即，它便燃烧起来，化为苍白短促的灰烬。

Writer of the Report: On the same day, the first and only Timekeeper who just took office, the twelve-year-old child, returned alone from the "Storm."
记录者：而在同一天，新上任的司辰，那个 12 岁的孩子，孤身一人从雨幕中返还。

Writer of the Report: She told us the time in the outside world at that point.
记录者：她告知了我们目前的外界时间。

Writer of the Report: And that was how I knew she was right.
记录者：是的。现在我知道了，她是对的。

"HER": "It is right in front of you."
“她”：“——它就在你的眼前。”

Writer of the Report: But, if there is a god, why are you playing such a prank on us, after we had suffered from the collapse of all the existing orders and the failure of all the great laws?
记录者：——可是，神啊，倘若一切既定的秩序都已经坍塌，任何伟大的定律都已经死去，你为何又要如此捉弄我们?

Writer of the Report: If this is what she called the glimpse of the supreme existence, the moment of afflatus, do you have to present it in such a cruel way?
记录者：——倘若真的存在至高力量的惊鸿一瞥，存在灵光一闪的心灵联结，你为何又要如此残酷地显现……?

Writer of the Report: The last two digits in the number of the year after that "Storm" were exactly her name ... and her number.
记录者：那个数字，这一次“暴雨”回退到的年代，20 世纪的后两位数，正是她的名字，她的数字。

Writer of the Report: 77.
记录者：77 年。

The report ends here.
记录就此中断。

Two digits. That's the full stop of the story.
结束在两个飞扬出去的数字上。

Matilda: Unbelievable ... Unbelievable! It's actually true! Someone did make that prophecy!
玛蒂尔达：不可思议……不可思议！竟然有这样的事！竟然真的有人做出过这种预言……！

Matilda: Vertin and Sonetto will be thrilled to know what we found!
玛蒂尔达：维尔汀和十四行诗一定会很高兴能得到这些信息的……！

Matilda: Well done, Ms. Sotheby! You performed as well as a formal investigator! We need to submit this report to your instructor immediately.
玛蒂尔达：做得漂亮，苏芙比小姐！这是可与正式职员媲美的实绩！我们得立刻向你的指导老师提交这份报告……

Grabbing the papers tightly, Matilda turns around with excitement.
玛蒂尔达攥紧纸张，从忘我的激动中扭过头去。

Sotheby isn't the person standing there.
那里站着的却并不是苏芙比。

???: What are you doing in other people's rooms?
???：……你们在别人的房间里干什么？

The report is snatched away.
记录被粗暴地从手里抽走了。

???: This is my personal item. You have no right to take it.
???：……这是我的私人物品，你们无权处置。

???: Please leave immediately.
???：请你们现在离开。

Matilda: P-Personal item?! This is a precious record that should have been submitted to the Foundation!
玛蒂尔达：什，什么私人物品！这是一份没有被正常提交的珍贵笔录资料！

Matilda: According to Administration and Regulations for Dispatched Personnel (St. Pavlov Foundation Decree No. 259),
玛蒂尔达：依照《对外派遣人员行为章程与管理条例》（基金会令第 259 号）——

Matilda: Every member of the Foundation, when acting as a field investigator, is required to create a comprehensive investigation report of all their actions and promptly submit it!
玛蒂尔达：每个基金会职员在作为外派调查员时，都需要对自己的一切行为形成完整的调查报告，并及时上交！

???: And they are obliged to ensure the authenticity, objectivity, and impartiality of the report. No personal bias is allowed in the content.
???：并有义务保证调查报告的真实、客观、公正，不掺杂个人立场。

???: If you have read this report, Miss, you should know that it's not even qualified to be filed.
???：如果你看过这份记录，小姐，就会知道它只配待在不合规报告的垃圾箱。

Matilda: Ugh! But this is an emergency!
玛蒂尔达：……呜！可是现在是特殊情况……！

The "Storm" Reformation Act is still new to her. She can't think of any articles to support her point of view.
“暴雨改革”法案通过的时间并不长，可以第一时间引用的条文也不多。

She racks her brains for words. But before she makes it, the other person starts talking, with one of his eyebrows raised.
纪律辅员拼命地在脑中搜罗用于反击的条文，而研究员已经讥讽地抬起眉毛。

???: I can tell from your uniform. You are a student of SPDM, or ...?
???：而且，你身上的制服好像是属于第一防线学校的。

???: This is Laplace. Do you have your guardian's approval to leave the school, Ms. Underage Student?
???: 这里是拉普拉斯科算中心。你有监护人的外出批条吗，这位未成年的学生小姐?

Matilda: A-Approval? I don't need that! I am not a student! You are talking to the exceptionally promoted monitor assistant of SPDM!
玛蒂尔达: 批，批条……我才不需要那种东西！我不是学生，我是第一防线学校破格录取的纪律辅员……!

Matilda: Here is my ID!
玛蒂尔达: 我有证件!

She holds her ID card high as if she's holding the flag of liberty.
玛蒂尔达气势如虹地举起了卡片。

But she is ignored. The adult walks directly to a swivel chair in the room and pays attention to an educational toy on the table.
而对方只是路过了她，在转椅上坐下，开始摆弄桌子上的益智摆件。

Matilda: Huh! Did you just ignore a formal administrator of the Foundation?! This monitor assistant will report every misbehavior of yours, every little bit of them!
玛蒂尔达: 你，你在忽视一位正式的基金会管理人员吗?!纪律辅员会把你的所有行为都如实上报的，所有行为!

Wordless, the monitor assistant can't be more embarrassed in her life. She looks around just to find that Sotheby is gone.
纪律辅员陷入了难言的困窘，她四处张望，却发现苏芙比的身影并不在旁。

Luckily, the chief assistant learns faster than she expects.
好在她一手指导的助理已经预先领悟了她的所有教诲。

The familiar sing-song tone is making a report to her own tutor outside the half-opened door.
半开的门外，稚嫩的声音正雀跃地报告着。

Sotheby: Ms. Moissan, we found that report here!
苏芙比: 莫桑老师，那份报告就在这里!

Sotheby: The great Ms. Bouanich and I discovered some important information. I came to you and Madam Z immediately after we read it.
苏芙比: 我和了不起的布翁尼小姐发现了重要的情报。所以我读完文件后，第一时间就来找您和 Z 女士了……

Sotheby: Hmm? Ms. Bouanich, why are you confronting Mr. Chair?
苏芙比: 咦……布翁尼小姐，你在和椅子先生吵架吗?

Sotheby stands at the door. Her head is tilted.
苏芙比将头往旁一歪。

Two adults are behind her.
她的身后站着两名成年的访客。

Z: I didn't expect to see the second half of that report here in your room, Adler.
Z: ……没想到那份报告的下半部分会在你的房间，阿德勒。

This time, the owner of the voice can't be ignored.
这是个不能当作没听到的声音。

The swivel chair unwillingly turns around.
椅子慢腾腾地转了过来。

Enigma: Don't call me that, friend. Why not just call me Enigma? Just like everyone else. Relax. I know nicknames mean no harm.
哑谜：换个名字，朋友。不如就用你们最乐意称呼的那个吧……“哑谜”？
……别担心，我明白取昵称的人没有恶意。

Enigma: But I don't understand. How is a report filled with meaningless words of any concern to you, Madam Z?
哑谜：只是我很怀疑，这几页意义不明、神神叨叨的东西，真的有惊动你的价值吗？

Z: It provides information about the arcanist group Vertin is now dealing with.
Z：是的，这有助于我们了解维尔汀接触的神秘学家团体。

Z: If possible, please give it to me.
Z：希望你能把它移交给我。

Enigma: Of course. How can I turn down the request from Constantine's chief of staff?
哑谜：康斯坦丁的幕僚长开口，我当然只会同意。

Enigma: Take it away. I hope you don't mind the mold on it.
哑谜：请拿去。希望你不要介意它在这个阴冷房间里长出的所有霉斑。

The researcher stays seated on the chair and casually hands out the report.
研究员并未从转椅上起身，只是随意地将报告往旁边一扬。

Madam Z smiles. She seems glad to see that Enigma still has the energy to be sarcastic.
Z 女士温和地笑了笑，像是在庆幸对方尚未锈蚀的锋刃。

But clearly, the monitor assistant can't tolerate such a blatant violation of the staff regulations.
但纪律辅员显然不会容忍如此违反规章的行为。

Matilda: Please pay attention to your manners and do not bring disgrace to the Computing Center, Mr. Rude!
玛蒂尔达：请你遵守身为科算中心人员的基本礼仪，无礼的家伙！

Ms. Moissan taps her on the shoulder and quickly looks in the direction of the door.
莫桑女士适时地拍了拍她的肩膀，向门外的方向简单示意。

Ms. Moissan: Ms. Bouanich, Ms. Sotheby, you've done a great job. I'm sure what you have found would be of great help to Timekeeper.
莫桑女士：布翁尼小姐，苏芙比小姐，你们做得很好，我相信这些信息会对司辰有所帮助的。

Ms. Moissan: And I will report your active performance in this mission to SPDM as soon as possible, Ms. Bouanich.
莫桑女士：同样，你的杰出贡献我会第一时间报告给第一防线学校的，布翁尼小姐。

Ms. Moissan: We need to further analyze the files you've found. The first on the scene could provide more detailed information. Let's get out of here.
莫桑女士：这些文档还需要进一步的分析，我想，第一现场的发现者能提供更多的信息。来，让我们先出去吧。

Matilda: A-Active performance ...!
玛蒂尔达：……杰，杰出贡献……！

The keywords give this young monitor assistant a giddy pleasure. She can't help but ignore everything else Ms. Moissan says.
年轻的纪律辅员几乎被这个词冲昏过去，再没注意到其他的话语。

Matilda: Hahaha, active ... No, no ... Calm down, Matilda ...
玛蒂尔达：哈哈哈，杰出……不，不，玛蒂尔达，冷静……

Matilda: I-I didn't accomplish it alone. Assistant Sotheby also played a significant role.
玛蒂尔达：这，这不全是我的功绩，苏芙比助理也起到了很大作用……

Sotheby: **Hooray!**
苏芙比：**好耶——！**

A loud cheer interrupts Matilda's mumbling.
淑女小声的嘀咕被巨大的欢呼打断了。

Sotheby: That is to say, Ms. Bouanich, we can start preparing the balloons and flowers for the twist ball!
苏芙比：也就是说，布翁尼小姐，我们可以开始准备扭扭舞会的气球和鲜花了！

Matilda: Ahem ... Speaking of which, this monitor assistant still needs to think about it. By the way, just call me Matilda.
玛蒂尔达：咳……关于舞会，纪律辅员还需要考虑一会儿。还有，你叫我玛蒂尔达就好了……

She struggles to get out of Sotheby's passionate hug. The great joy brought by Ms. Moissan makes her actions clumsy.
玛蒂尔达吃力地将苏芙比热情的双手别开，脚步不稳地迈向走廊。

Cheering and discussing, the girls leave the room.
年轻的女孩们吵闹着离开了。

Madam Z carefully puts the valuable report away.
Z 女士也慎重收起了那份得之不易的报告。

Enigma: ...
哑谜：……

The researcher swivels the chair again and hides himself in the fortress made of dusty items.
研究员又回到了他转椅前的壁垒中。

He talks, through cabinets and equipment, in a slow manner.
隔着数排布满灰尘的杂物，他慢慢地开口了。

Enigma: There will be no advance in human technology. You think so?
哑谜：……人类的科技已经无法再前进了。你也这么想吗?

Enigma: Even the Madam Z has given up on the study of theoretical physics and become a politician.
哑谜：连你也放弃了理论物理，投向了政治。

Z: ...
Z: ……

Z: No. I've never thought of that.
Z: 不，我从来没有这么想过。

She turns to the door with a faint smile.
她转向了来时的方向，带着若有似无的笑意。

Click.
“——咔。”

The door is closed.
门关上了。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

新航向
New Direction 5SP-06

New Direction
新航向

The dramas have ended.
所有喧嚣的插曲都离开了。

All is profoundly hushed in this cold and dark room.
这处阴冷的角落又恢复了寂静。

The researcher sighs and starts settling the messy papers and dusty tools on the table.
研究员叹了一口气，开始收拾桌上杂乱的文件和沾灰的器械。

Why is it mistaken for a utility room? Is it because of the mess?
是因为太过凌乱，才被误以为是杂物间的吗?

Metallic footsteps come from outside the door.
门口响起了清脆的脚步声。

???: I am astonished by the fact that you were interacting with others.
???: 意外事件。你竟然主动和人进行了交流。

Another trespasser.
又是一个不征求意见便闯入房间的人。

Enigma: They broke in.
哑谜: ……是她们非得闯进来的。

The robot in charge of the Laplace Scientific Computing Center shrugs and refuses to make any comments. She has already heard all the information she needs in the corridor.
拉普拉斯的总负责人不置可否地耸了耸肩。她已在走廊上了解到了必要的信息。

???: If it was a complaint that you were making, you know it is within your rights to submit an interdepartmental complaint within seven days after the incident.
???: 如果你对此不满，可以在 7 天内提交跨部门行政申诉。

Enigma: Don't bother. That file means nothing to me.
哑谜: 不了，那份文件本来就对我毫无价值。

Enigma: I didn't file it because it's a report against the rules. Why bother to submit such a log full of personal feelings and emotional behaviors to our great, rigorous Foundation?
哑谜: 我扣下它，只是因为它是一本记录了诸多违规行为的非法报告。这种全是私人情绪的记录，有什么递交给我们严谨、务实、伟大的管理机构的必要?

???: Is that so?
???: 是这样吗?

???: I am gratified to find that you still have some sense.
???: 很高兴你对价值还有一些基于理性的判断。

Enigma: I, too, am gratified that you still have no idea that I was being sarcastic.
哑谜: 很高兴你还是一点都听不出反讽。

???: Oh. That was sarcasm.
???: 噢，所以刚刚这句是反讽。

Enigma: ...
哑谜: ……

Enigma: Never mind. What do you want from me, Madam Lucy?
哑谜：无所谓了——你找我有什么事，露西女士?

He asks as he bends down and organizes the papers scattered all over the place.
研究员弯下腰，开始捡拾那些因无人关心而躺在地上许久的凌乱纸张。

This is the best effort he cares to make to receive a guest.
这是他最高规格的迎宾礼遇。

Enigma: You went all the way to this dusty, run-down place so hurriedly that you even forgot to put on that pathetic mask. This is not because of some old files, I assume?
哑谜：你专程来这样一个落灰的小地方，甚至没来得及带上那张假脸。
这应该不是为了什么发霉的陈年报告，对吗?

The faceless robot inclines its head in agreement.
无脸的机器微微颔首，似乎在赞同这番话的合理性。

Lucy: Certainly.
露西：当然。

Lucy: I hope you can be the cryptographer of the Manus Vindictae's ritual. You are still the best.
露西：我希望你来破译重塑之手的术式。你仍是我们最好的密码学家。

Enigma: You're asking me, a human, to decode the ritual of a pure-blood arcanist group?
哑谜：……让一个人类的研究员，去破译一个纯血神秘学团体所用的术式?

Enigma: I don't see how I'll be helpful to this project.
哑谜：我看不出我对这个项目会有任何价值。

Lucy: You cannot evaluate your own level of being of value, Adler.
露西：有无价值不是你评估的，阿德勒。

The researcher keeps unfolding more dusty folders without raising his eyes from the table.
研究员头也不抬，只是继续把更多沾灰的文件摊在桌上。

Enigma: Well, you evaluate our value, test us in experiments you set, prove the hypotheses by exhaustion, make mistakes, and start all over again. You repeat the process, like a roaring locomotive that pulls the research center out of this chaotic disaster.
哑谜：是啊，你们评估，你们实验，你们穷举，你们试错。就像一台永不停歇的引擎，带着科算中心在这场混乱的雨幕中突进。

Enigma: You question not what is ahead of you, nor whether the path you've taken will be regular or easy. The only idea you planted into your little brain is to move forward, to "improve."
哑谜：无所谓道路是打结还是转圈，也无所谓时间是前进还是倒退，只需要知道自己在前进——朝改善现状前进。

Lucy: Thank you for your compliment. Credit goes to everyone.
露西：感谢你的称赞，这是我们所有人的荣耀。

Enigma: That was not even a ... Never mind.
哑谜：我没有在称赞……算了。

Enigma: Guess you agree, a life without creativity is not worth living, and that's the life that I wake up to every day. I'm no longer the person you thought you came here for.
哑谜：——想必你也同意，没有创造力的生活是不值得一过的。而我已经彻底失去了这种能力。

Enigma: I'll never be able to combine human technology and arcanum, and I'll never comprehend even the slightest part of it.
哑谜：我没有你们所需的那种将人类科技和神秘学结合的能力，我无法理解神秘学哪怕一星半点。

Enigma: I am useless to you.
哑谜：所以，我总归是没有用的。

He squares up the paper on the desk in a grumpy manner, making a huge knocking noise.
他将文件收拢，在桌面上叩出粗暴的声响。

Enigma: I don't expect someone made of tin to understand the human mind, but I beg of you: leave me alone.
哑谜：我不指望你这块铁皮能理解人类心灵的结构——但至少让我清静一点吧。

The robot ignores his emotional speech and keeps talking.
机器并未理睬这番情绪化的发言。

Lucy: The work of analyzing the masks of Manus Vindicate did not go well.
露西：我们对重塑之手面具的解析并不顺利。

Lucy: A side effect occurs in the researchers, and it is getting worse. The isolation wards on the basement level are overwhelmed.
露西：副作用正在科算中心蔓延，地下一层的隔离病房已经人满为患。

Enigma: What a scene! Have you aborted the experiment?
哑谜：真是不得了的症状啊，那你试过中止研究了吗?

Lucy: Not yet.
露西：没有。

Lucy: We have conducted the arcanum imaging experiment on the masks and found the component which also exists in the raindrops of the "Storm."
露西：我们对面具进行了显影实验，在其中找到了与“暴雨”雨滴一致的成分。

Lucy: But knowing what it is composed of does not help explain how it works. What we are looking for is the original ritual that the Manus cast on them.
露西：但解明它的成分，无助于推导它的原理。我们需要找到重塑之手使用的原始免疫术式。

Enigma: Ha. You are trying to figure out one's career planning from one's physical examination report. I wonder why it is not working.
哑谜：哈，这是当然了。你当然无法从一个人的体检报告推断出他的职业规划!

Enigma: Even if somehow you managed to find the original ritual, you still need a proper environment to test it, which is the outside world with a coming "Storm."
哑谜：而且，即使你们找到了原始术式，也缺乏验证的环境。它只会在“暴雨”到来的外界生效。

The researcher turns to her. Wisdom and sarcasm glow in his eyes.
研究员的眼睛里闪烁着讥诮的智慧光芒。

Enigma: That's why we can't tell if we're getting the results even if we have the right ritual, proper permission from the Foundation to travel, and strong-minded volunteer subjects.
哑谜：所以，即便我们拥有了正确的术式，合乎规定的外出许可，还有意志高洁的志愿者，我们也无法得知自己是否取得了成果。

Enigma: Experiments performed in the ivory tower won't succeed, because—
哑谜：因为任何在象牙塔里的试验都是无用的。

Lucy: An experiment about the "Storm" can only be done in a "Storm."
露西：——“暴雨”研究只能在“暴雨”里完成。

Lucy: Glad to see your brain is not rusty yet. It only took you three sentences to draw the conclusion, which took the seminar a week to reach.
露西：很高兴看到你的头脑还算灵活，只用三句话就得出了我们这一周研讨会的全部成果。

Lucy: That proves you are capable of the project.
露西：我想这足以证明你完全能胜任这项工作。

Enigma: ...
哑谜：……

The robot in charge puts a document on the table.
总负责人将一份档案放到桌上。

Lucy: The History Maintainence Team has forecast different critical points of this "Storm." Foundation investigators are on their way.
露西：基金会已经派出调查员，前往这次历史维护小组预报的诸个临界点。

Lucy: If Manus Vindictae still plans to accelerate the "Storm" like what they have done in 1929, there will be a high possibility that their people will show up at the transformation point of history and society—also known as the critical point of time, the center of the "Storm."
露西：如果重塑之手仍打算像 1929 年一样人为加速“暴雨”，那么历史和社会的变革之处——时代的临界点，“暴雨”的中心处——很可能会再度出现他们的踪影。

Lucy: Your sister, Greta Hofmann, is also one of the investigators.
露西：这次外派的成员中，也包括你的姐姐，格蕾塔·霍夫曼。

Enigma: I have no interest in any Hofmanns other than myself. We have different perspectives.
哑谜：……我对她的动向不感兴趣。我们的立场并不相同。

Lucy: It is okay. I am just here to inform you that ...
露西：无妨。我只是想告诉你，阿德勒。

Lucy: If any of the investigators successfully send the information of the ritual back, the research about the immunity of the "Storm" will be conducted immediately.
露西：倘若有任何一人成功传回术式，免疫“暴雨”的研究就会立刻开始。

Lucy: Take your time and be mentally prepared. But once the "Storm" alert is issued, we only have 24 hours to verify the feasibility of the ritual.
露西：你花多少时间来做心理建设都无妨。但“暴雨”预警一旦出现，我们只有 24 小时来验证。

Lucy: I wish you will be fully prepared by then.
露西：希望你那时已做好了准备。

The robot gets out of the room, leaving him no right to choose. Her feet crash into the floor, making a steely sound.
她迈着钢铁的脚步离开了，并未留下任何拒绝的空间。

Enigma's eyes flicker toward the document. The face on the top is familiar to him.
研究员将目光移向那份档案。最上方那张照片的面容还算熟悉。

He pulls out the drawer and takes out a scrap of paper.
他拉开抽屉，从中拿出一张残页。

This is the last code he didn't give anyone.
这是尚未交出的最后一份密码。

Writer of the Report: One thing is for sure now ...
记录者：如今，我可以笃信的是……

Writer of the Report: The age of humans has come to an end.
记录者：——人类的时代已经结束了。

THE END
THE END